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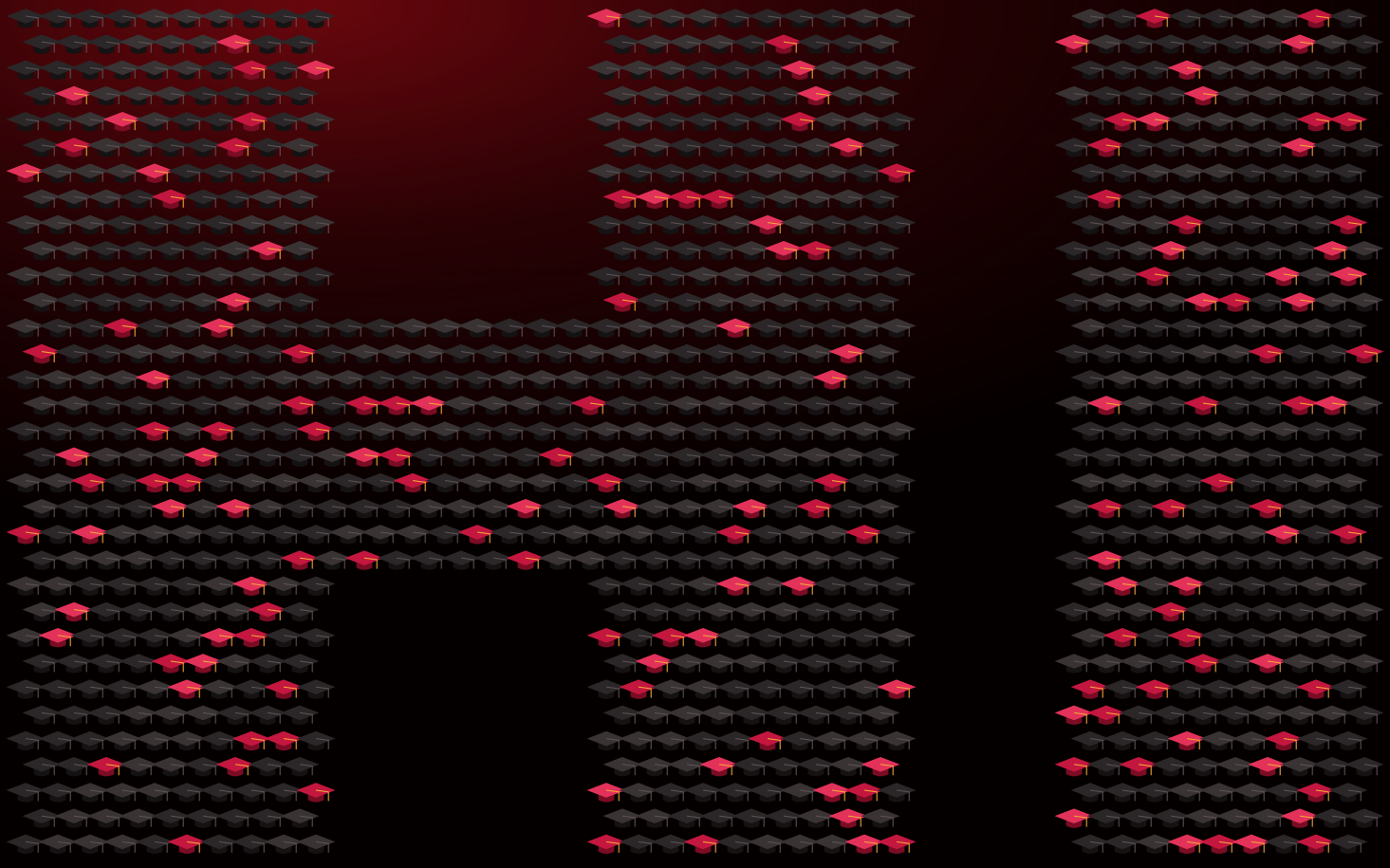
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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **16 in every 100**, mark the international share of Hawaii's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to Hawaii: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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How to Cite this Profile

Emerson V. Johnston and Amy Zegart, “The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile,” Technology Policy Accelerator, Hoover Institution, and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence, Stanford University, Stanford, CA, November 2026.

Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 Hawaii Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What Hawaii's numbers say

1. **International students earn 16% of Hawaii's STEM master's degrees,** 36.1 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 46th of 51 on dependence. The share is 35% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 8.3% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **Hawaii awarded 40 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.0% of the U.S. total and 47th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed −15%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in engineering,** where international students earned 17% of master's degrees (76 degrees; U.S. 49%). No STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** Hawaii ranks 5th of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: Hawaii 16%, Delaware 72%, South Dakota 48%, North Dakota 36%, Rhode Island 47%.
5. **73% of Hawaii's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 5.3% came from abroad. More residents left for other states (3.98K) than students arrived from them (1.79K), a net loss of 2.19K; the top destination for those leaving was California.

16%

of the STEM master's degrees Hawaii awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

HAWAII · STATE TALENT PROFILE

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

61.4K #44
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −11% since 2015

40 #47
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K**

16% #46
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · −2.9 pp since 2015

10% #36
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · −1.8 pp since 2015

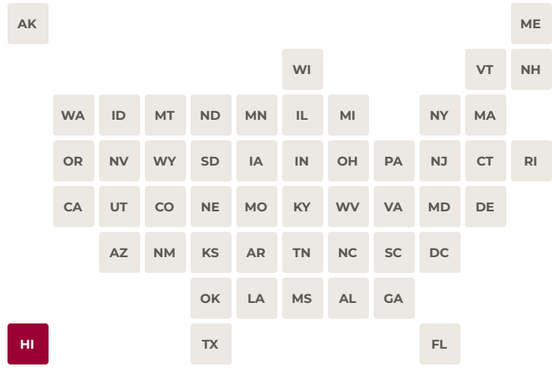
20% #42
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +4.4 pp since 2015

56% #42
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +6.1 pp since 2015

$16.9K #7
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +36% since 2015

73% #24
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · −4.2 pp since 2016

$110K #13
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −4.2% since 2016



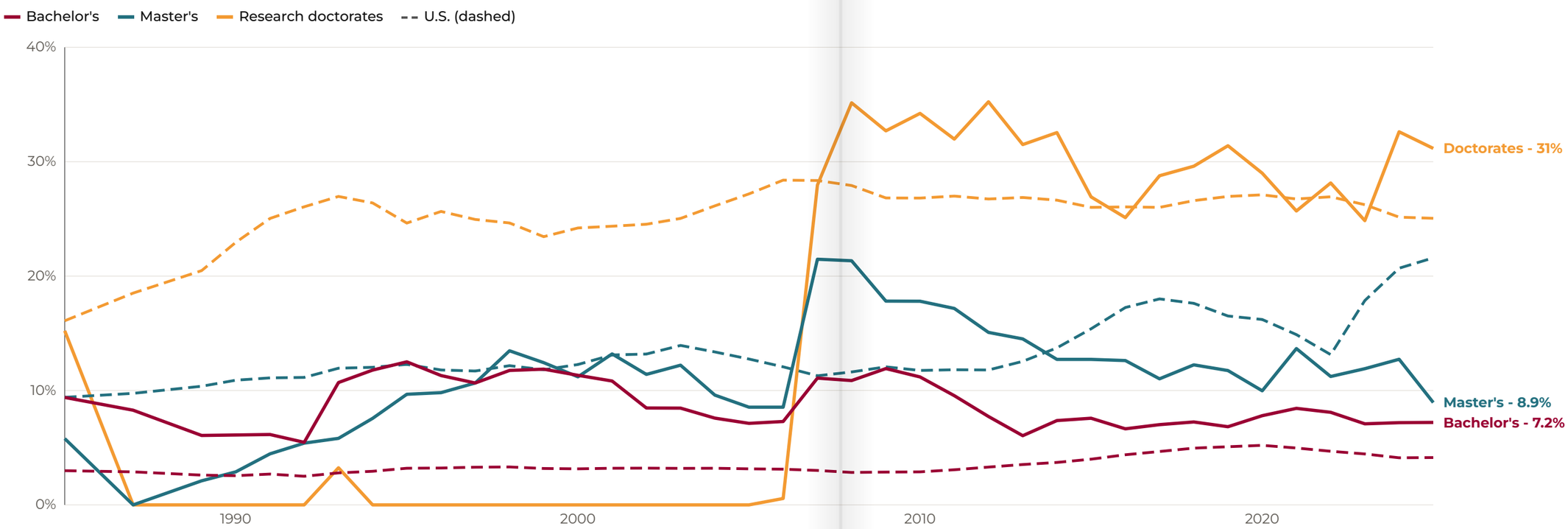
Badges give Hawaii's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

Hawaii ranks 46th of 51 on the international share of STEM master's, at 16% in 2025 against 52% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of Hawaii's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 10% of Hawaii's graduate enrollment and 6.2% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 7.2% of bachelor's, 8.9% of master's and 31% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 8.3% of STEM bachelor's, 16% of STEM master's and 35% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.0% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 47th of 51.

10%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **36th** of 51 · −1.8 pp since 2015

8.9%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

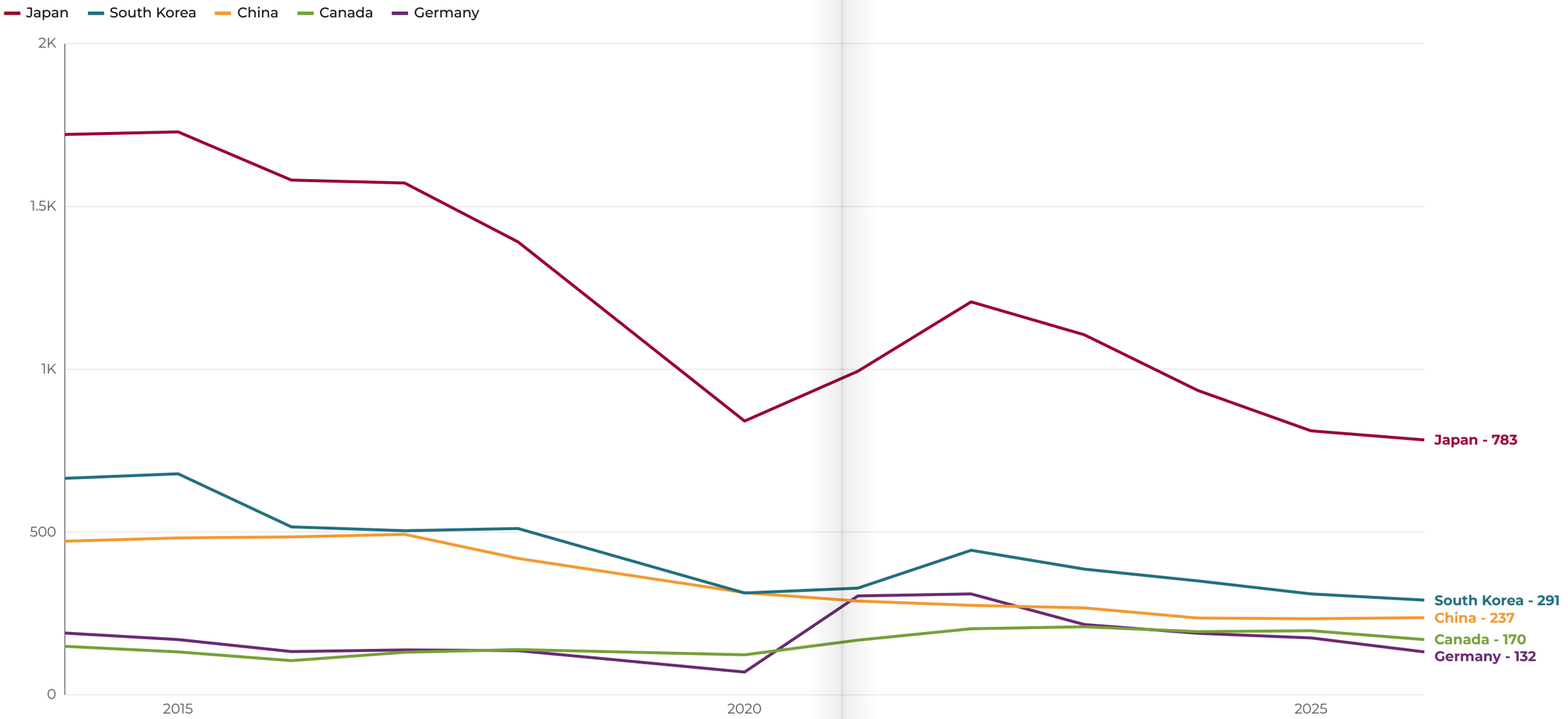
U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

16%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **46th** of 51 · −2.9 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do Hawaii's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, Hawaii had 2.68K active international students in SEVIS, 44th of 51. Japan accounted for 29% of them and South Korea for 11%, against 1.2% and 3.5% nationally.

Students came from 101 countries, but the two largest supplied 40%. The state's total is down 44% since 2015, when it stood at 4.8K.

2.68K
Active international students, October 2026
44th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

29%
From Japan
U.S. **1.2%**

26%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

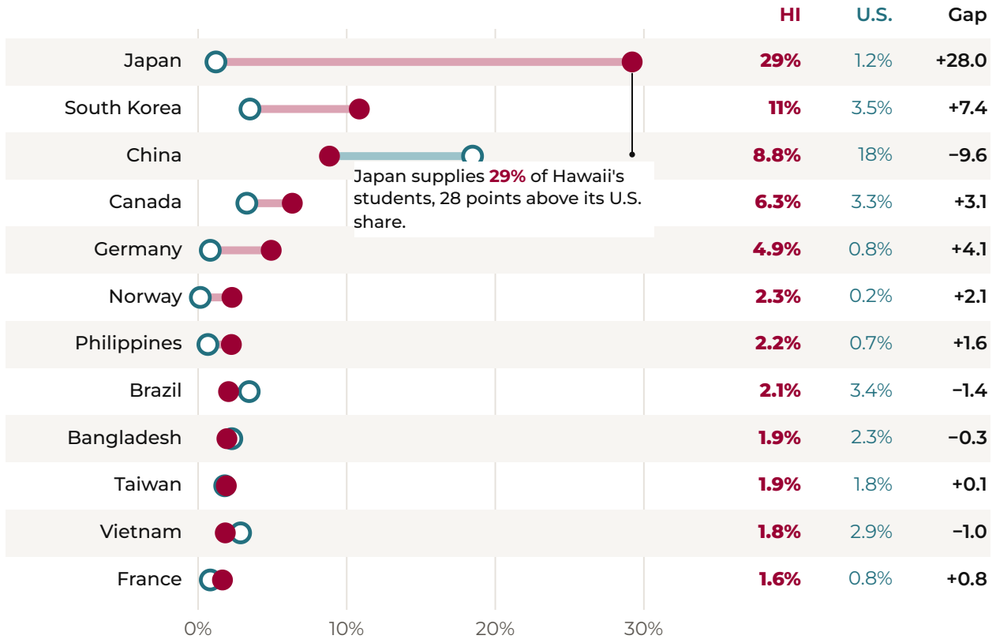
How Does Hawaii's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, Hawaii had **2.68K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 44th among the 50 states and DC and **0.2%** of the U.S. total. They came from 101 countries.

Japan supplied **29%** of them, against 1.2% nationally, and South Korea **11%**, against 3.5%. China (8.8%), Canada (6.3%), and Germany (4.9%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **40%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 23rd among the states, against 50% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is Hawaii's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

2.68K
Active international students, October 2026
44th of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

29%
From Japan
U.S. **1.2%**

11%
From South Korea
U.S. **3.5%**

101
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is down 6.9% from 2025 and down 44% since 2015, when it stood at 4.8K. Its share of all U.S. international students is down 0.2 points since 2015, to **0.2%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Japan went from 1.73K to 783, South Korea's from 679 to 291, and China's from 482 to 237.

Over the same years, the number from Canada went from 132 to 170 and Germany's from 170 to 132. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in Hawaii, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	4.8K	2.88K	**2.68K**	−44%	1.19M	44th
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	0.2%	**0.2%**	−0.2 pp	–	44th
Countries of citizenship represented	114	106	**101**	−11%	219	48th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	50%	39%	**40%**	−10.1 pp	45%	23rd
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Japan	1.73K	811	**783**	−55%	1.2%	29%
South Korea	679	310	**291**	−57%	3.5%	11%
China	482	234	**237**	−51%	18%	8.8%
Canada	132	197	**170**	+29%	3.3%	6.3%
Germany	170	175	**132**	−22%	0.8%	4.9%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply Hawaii's International STEM Students?

688 of Hawaii's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **26%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 27% since 2015.

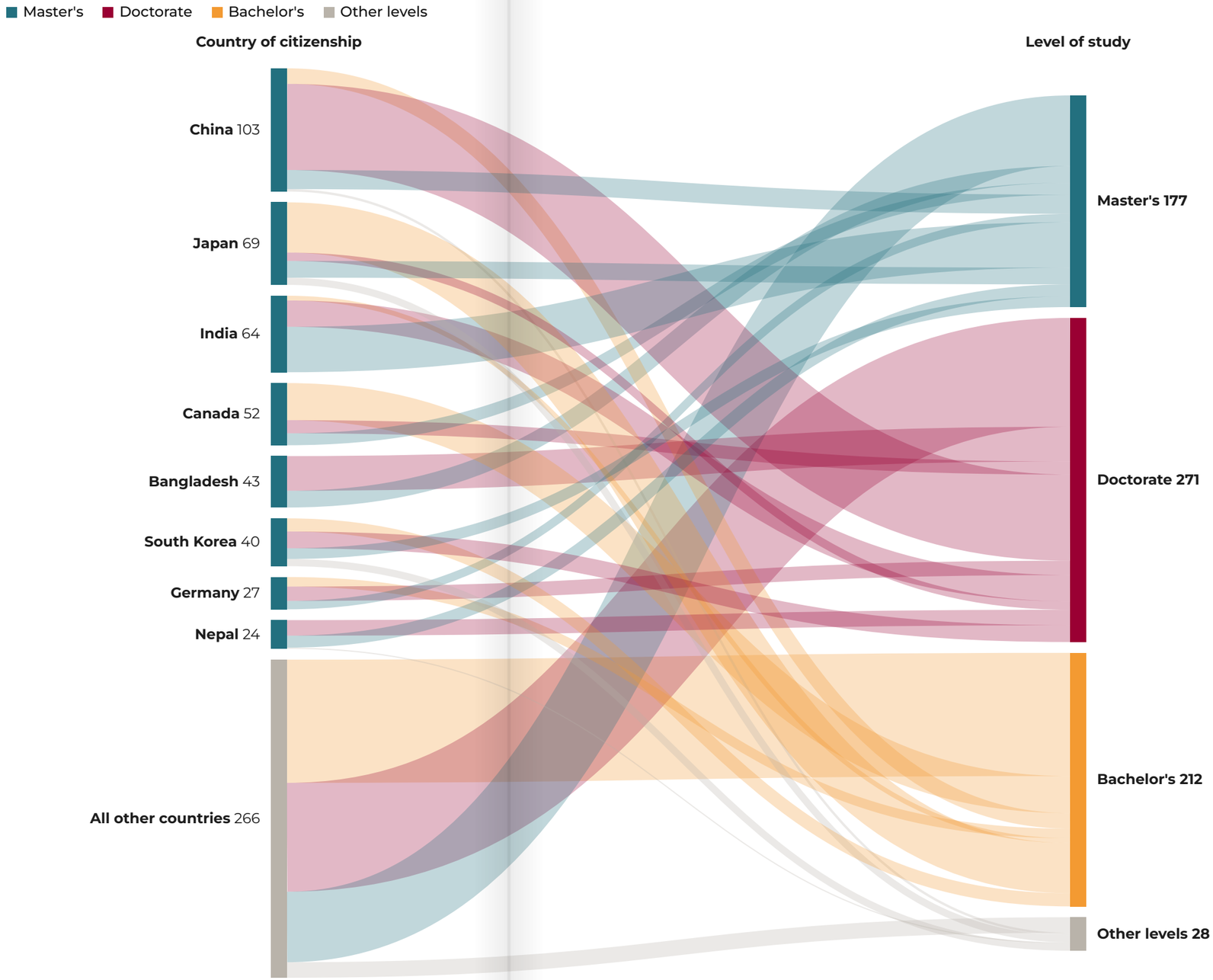
Doctoral students were the largest group, **271**. China supplied 27% of them and Bangladesh 11%.

STEM doctoral students went from 174 in 2015 to **271**, and STEM master's students from 104 to 177.

688
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **47th** of 51 · +27% since 2015

26%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

177
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **47th** of 51 · +70% since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

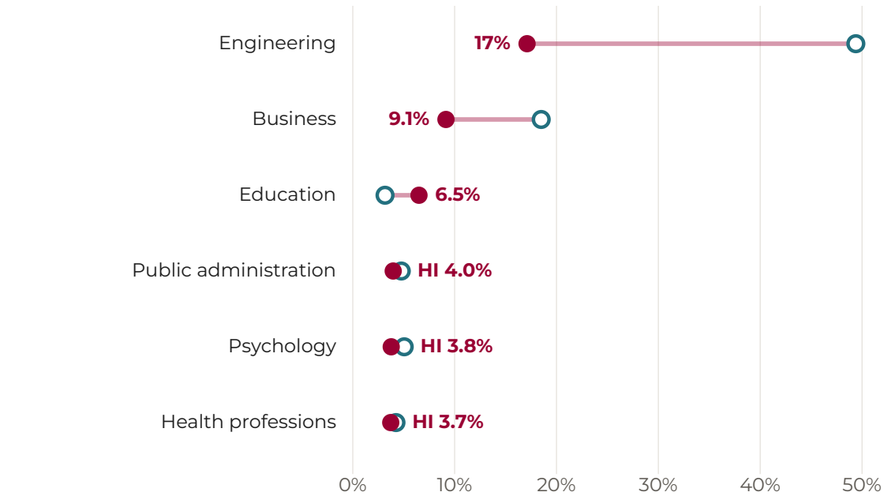
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are Hawaii's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in Hawaii in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in engineering (17%, against 49% for the U.S.), business (9.1%, against 19% for the U.S.), and education (6.5%, against 3.2% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

8.9%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51

16%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **46th** of 51

20%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **44th** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: Hawaii first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 17% of the master's degrees in engineering, against 49% for the U.S.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	15% / 8.6%	**20% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	2.0% / 7.2%	**17% / 49%**	61% / 55%
Engineering technology	– / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	8.3% / 17%	**– / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	5.1% / 6.0%	**15% / 33%**	25% / 38%
Biological sciences	9.1% / 3.4%	**19% / 23%**	33% / 23%
Natural resources	7.1% / 2.0%	**10% / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	0.0% / 7.3%	**4.5% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in Hawaii / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

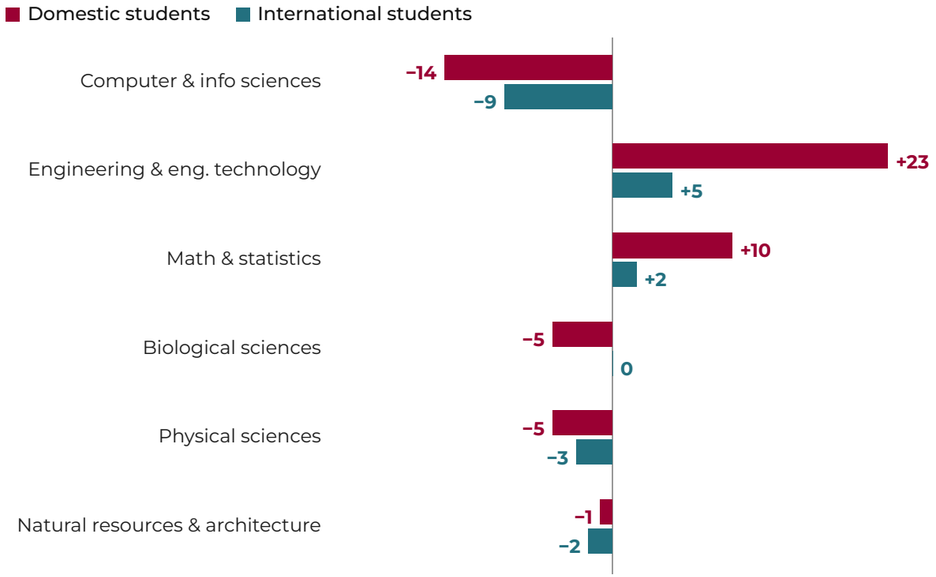
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has Hawaii's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Hawaii between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 250 in 2025 and 249 in 2015, a change of −7 for international students and +8 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

40
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **47th** of 51

17%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **35th** of 51

0.0%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
47th of 51

2.6
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **49th** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in Hawaii in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 17% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 35th among the states, up 1.9 points from 15% in 2024 and up 3.5 points since 2015, when it was 13%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	68	**45**	−34%	9	26%	20%
Engineering & eng. technology	48	**76**	–	13	17%	17%
Math & statistics	7	**19**	–	4	–	–
Biological sciences	37	**32**	–	6	16%	19%
Physical sciences	35	**27**	–	4	20%	–
Natural resources & architecture	54	**51**	−5.6%	4	11%	7.8%

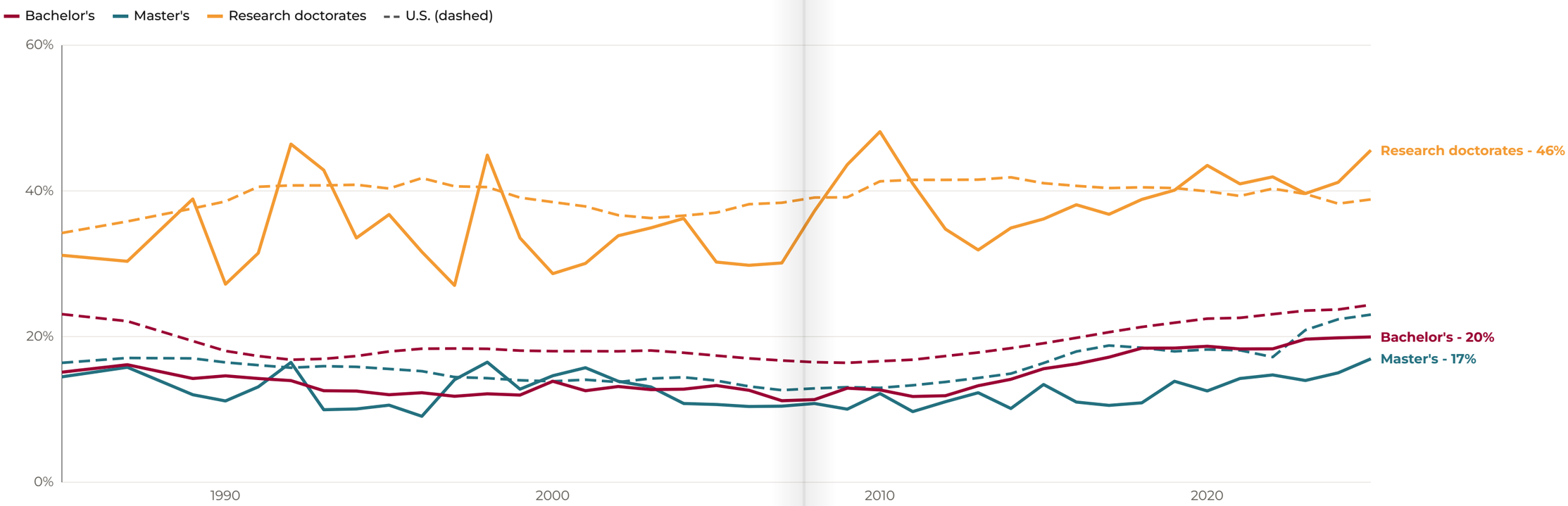
STEM master's degrees awarded in Hawaii, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

Hawaii ranks 42nd of 51 on the STEM share of bachelor's, at 20% in 2025 against 24% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of Hawaii's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 20% of Hawaii's bachelor's degrees, 17% of its master's and 46% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

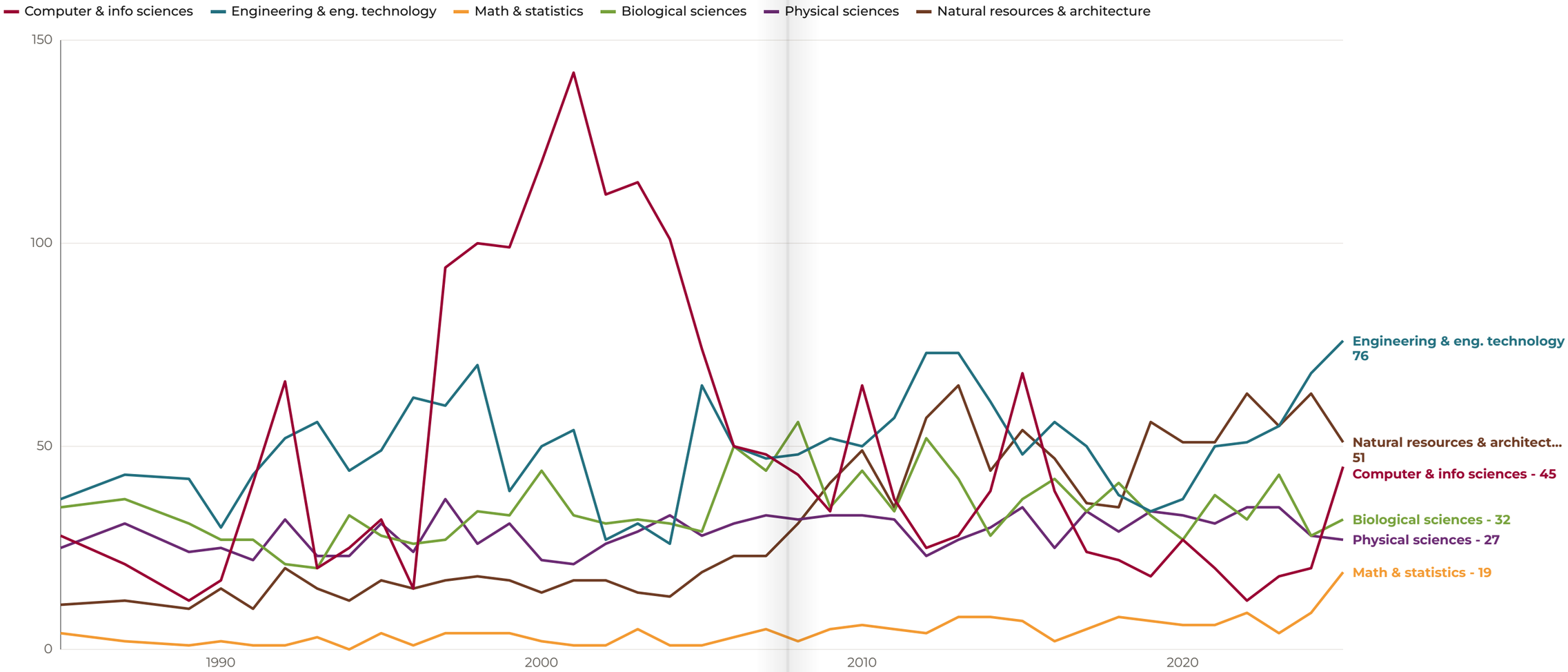
The STEM share of master's degrees is up 3.5 points since 2015, and the state ranks 35th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 42nd of 51.

20%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **42nd** of 51 · +4.4 pp since 2015

17%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **35th** of 51 · +3.5 pp since 2015

46%
STEM share of research doctorates, 2025
U.S. **39%** · **18th** of 51 · +9.4 pp since 2015

Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce Hawaii's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Engineering & eng. technology produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 76, followed by natural resources & architecture (51) and computer & info sciences (45). Master's degrees in engineering & eng. technology are up 58% since 2015.

International students earned 40 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.0% of the national total (47th of 51).

40

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **47th** of 51

0.0%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

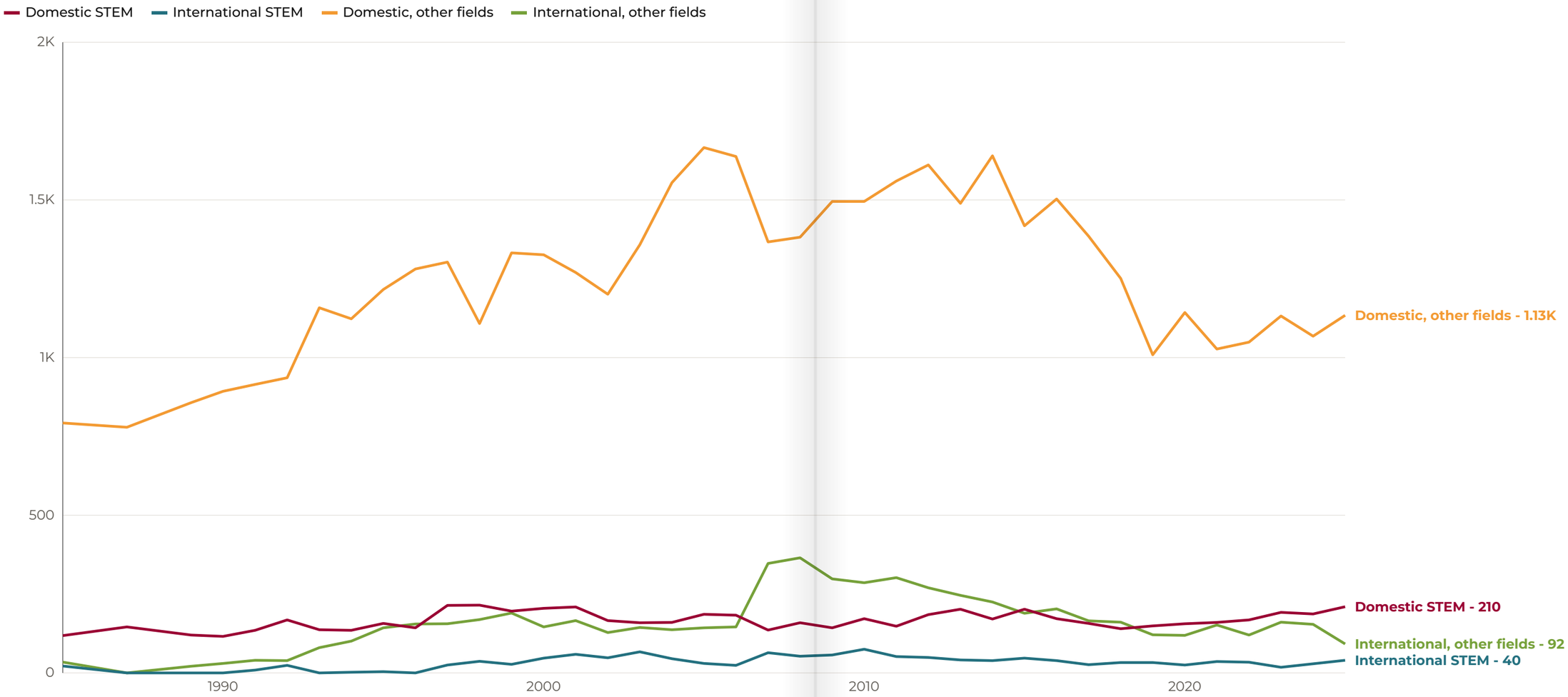
· **47th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

20%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **44th** of 47 · −6.5 pp since 2015

Figure 9 Who Earns Hawaii's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, –7 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 8 more to domestic students.

International students earn 16% of Hawaii's STEM master's but 7.5% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

8.9%

Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51 · –3.8 pp since 2015

16%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **46th** of 51 · –2.9 pp since 2015

2.6

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **49th** of 51 · –0.1 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

Hawaii ranks 49th of 51 on net student migration, at −21 in 2024.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

6.26K residents stayed in Hawaii for college in fall 2024; 1.79K students arrived from other states and 455 from abroad, while 3.98K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 73% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

73%

First-time students from in state, 2024

· **24th** of 51 · −4.2 pp since 2016

5.3%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

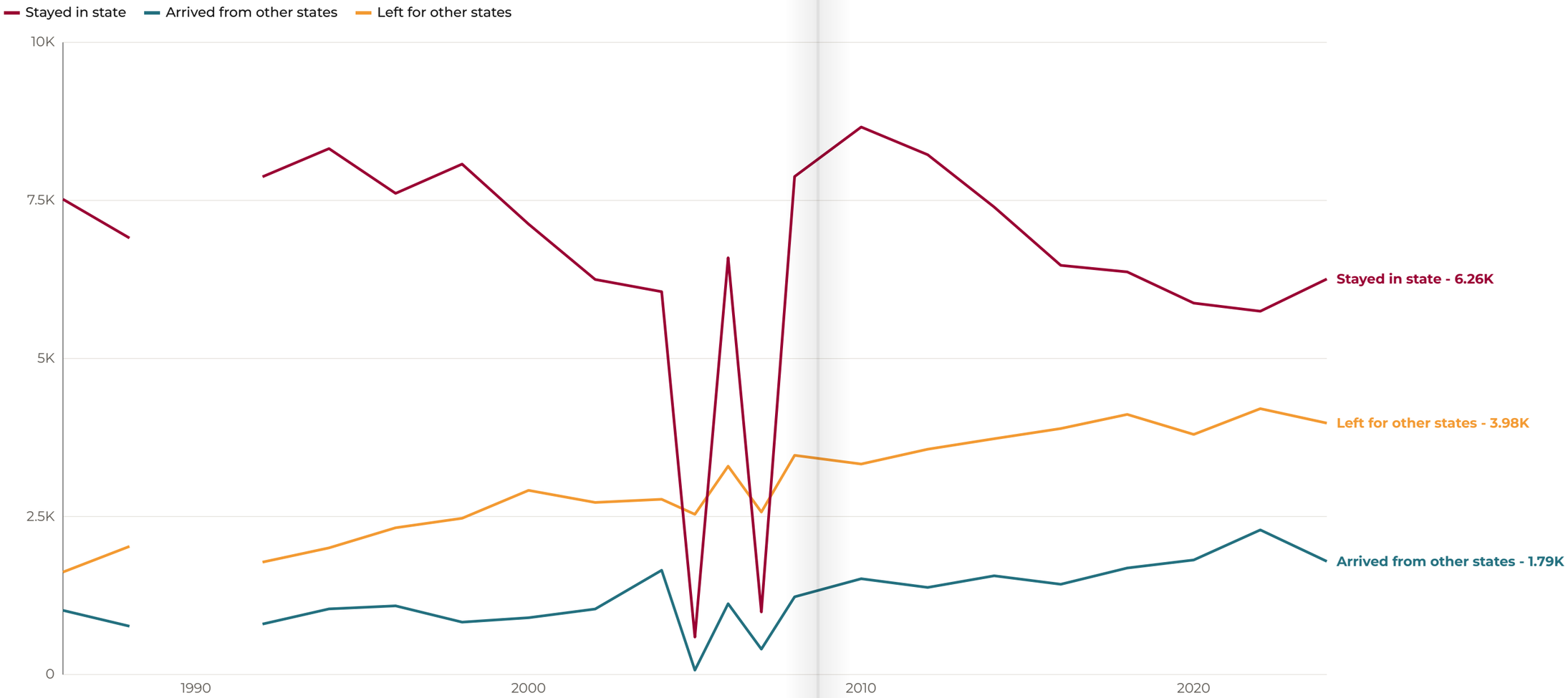
U.S. **3.1%** · **5th** of 51 · +0.8 pp since 2016

−21

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

· **49th** of 51 · +2.4 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 3%, arrivals from other states are up 25%, and residents leaving are up 2%.

Net migration was −21 per 100 resident first-time students (49th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was California (860).

Figure 12

Where Do Hawaii's Newcomers Come From?

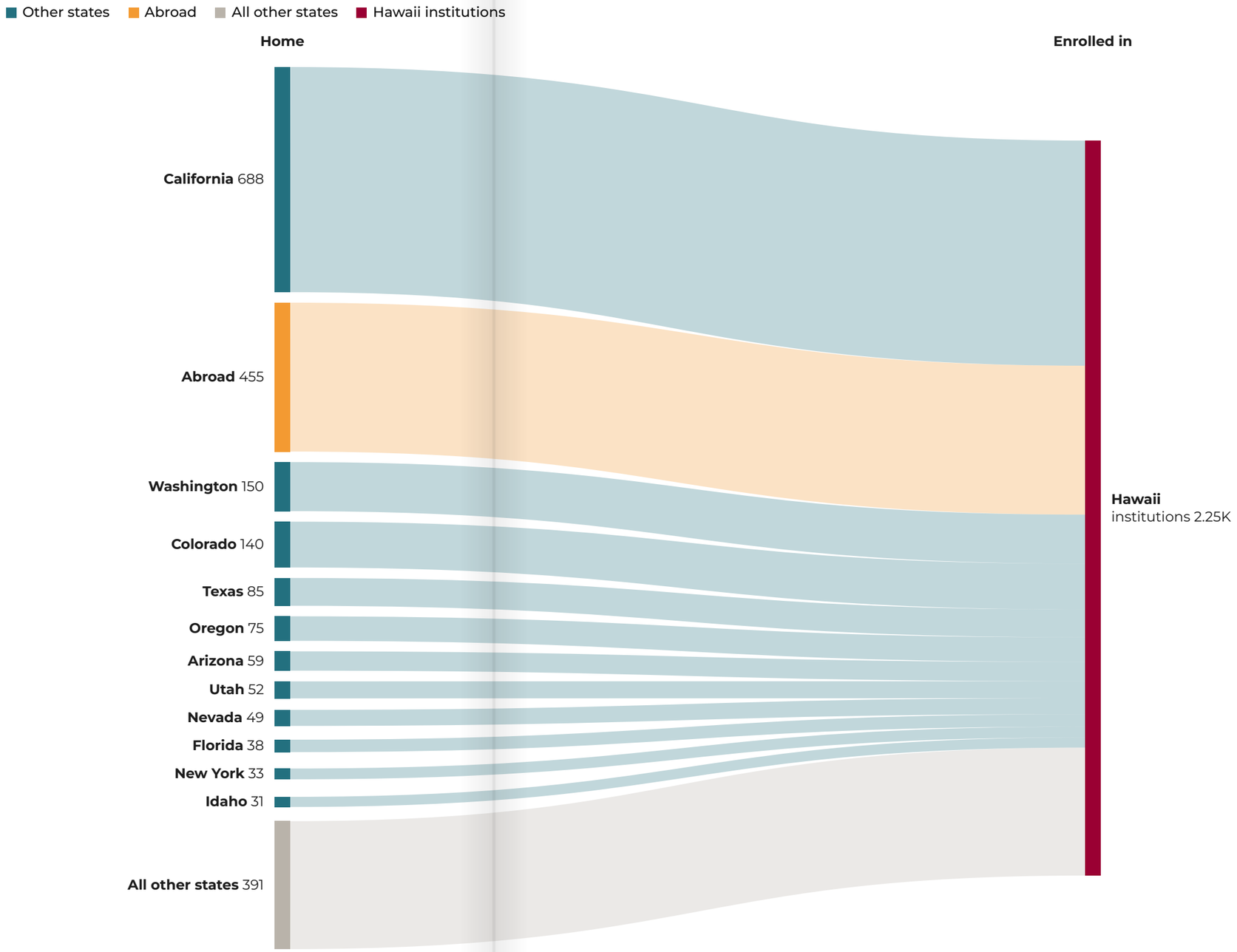
The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at Hawaii's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

Students arriving from other states. The number was 1.79K in fall 2024, down 22% from 2.29K in fall 2022 and up 25% since fall 2016, when it was 1.43K.

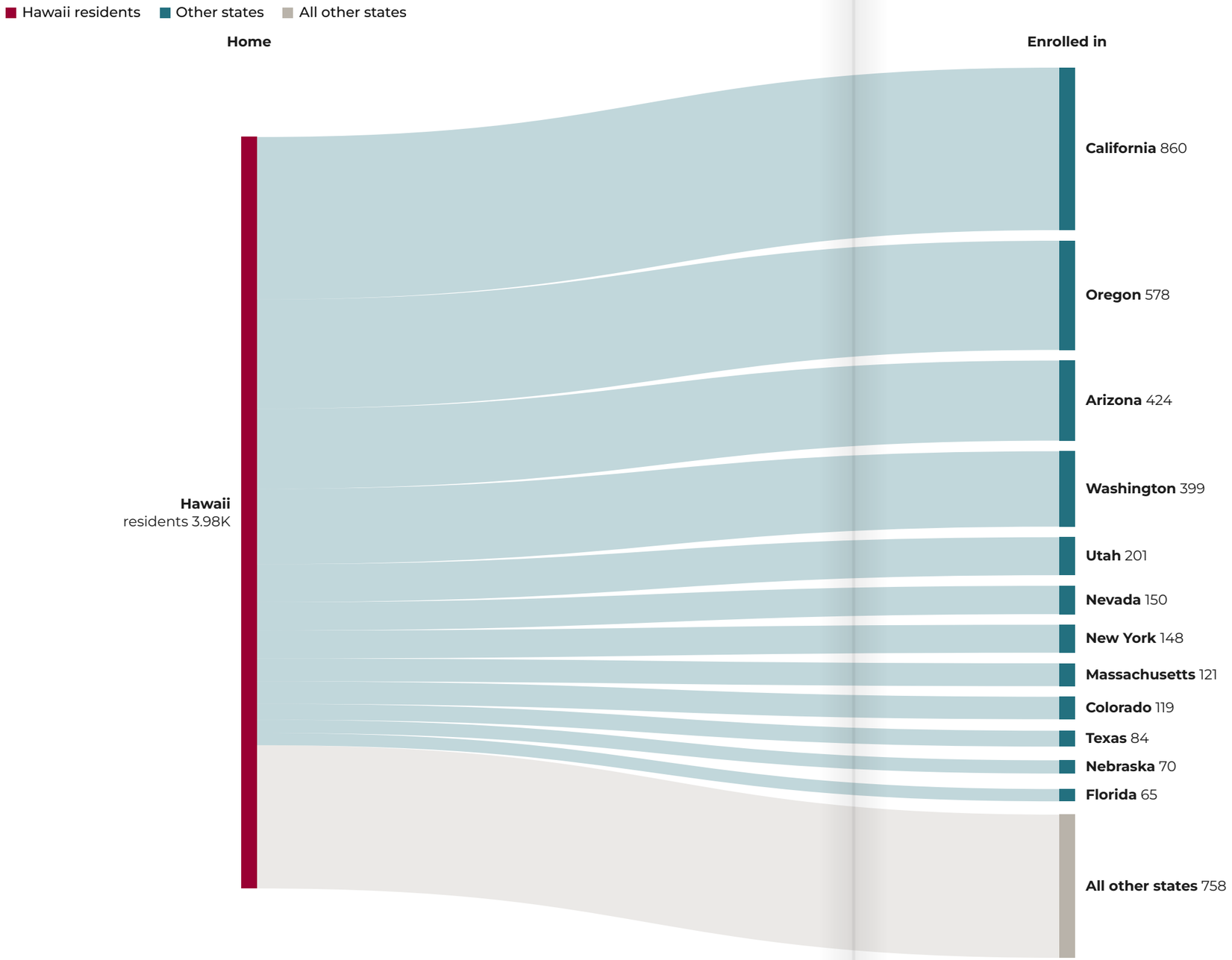
2.25K
First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024
Abroad **455**

5.3%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **5th** of 51 · +0.8 pp since 2016

73%
First-time students from in state, 2024
24th of 51 · −4.2 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do Hawaii's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where Hawaii residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 3.98K in fall 2024, down 5.4% from 4.21K in fall 2022 and up 2.2% since fall 2016, when it was 3.89K.

3.98K

Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024

Arrived from other states **1.79K** · **2.25K** with abroad

−21

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

49th of 51 · +2.4 since 2016

860

Went to California

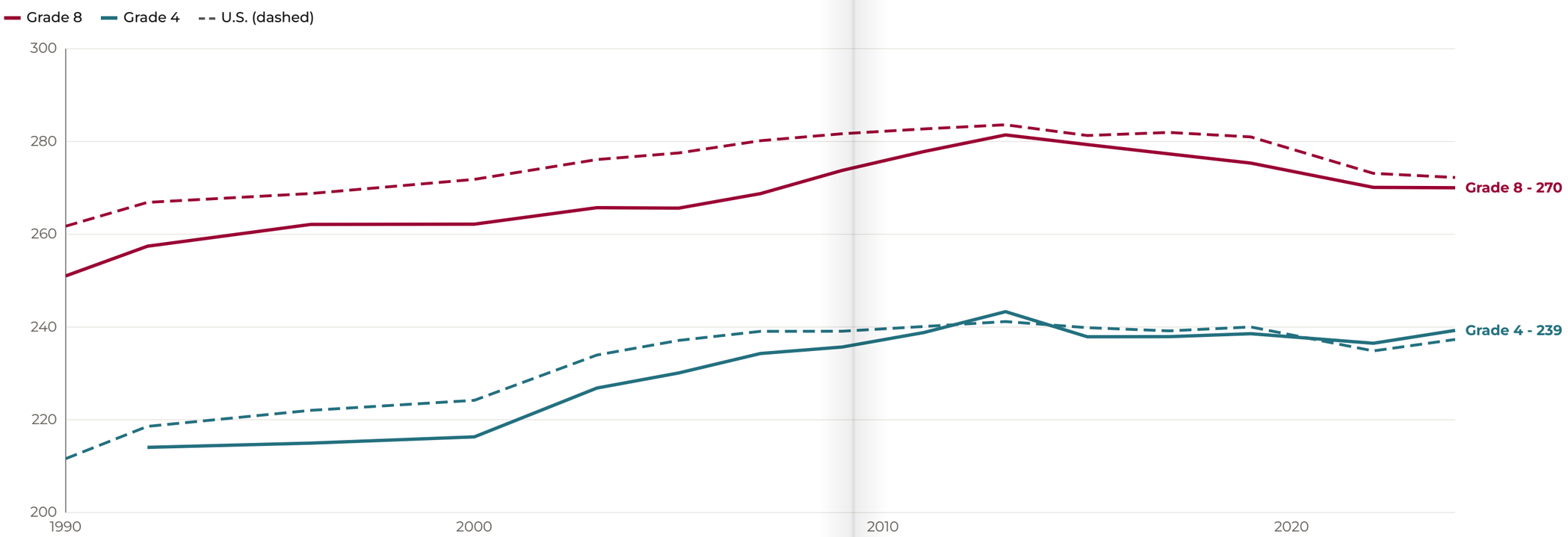
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

Hawaii ranks 38th of 51 on the share of grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient, at 23% in 2024 against 27% for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are Hawaii's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. Hawaii's eighth graders averaged 270 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 30th of 51 among the states.

23% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

270

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **30th** of 51 · −9.3 since 2015

23%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **38th** of 51 · −6.9 pp since 2015

257

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

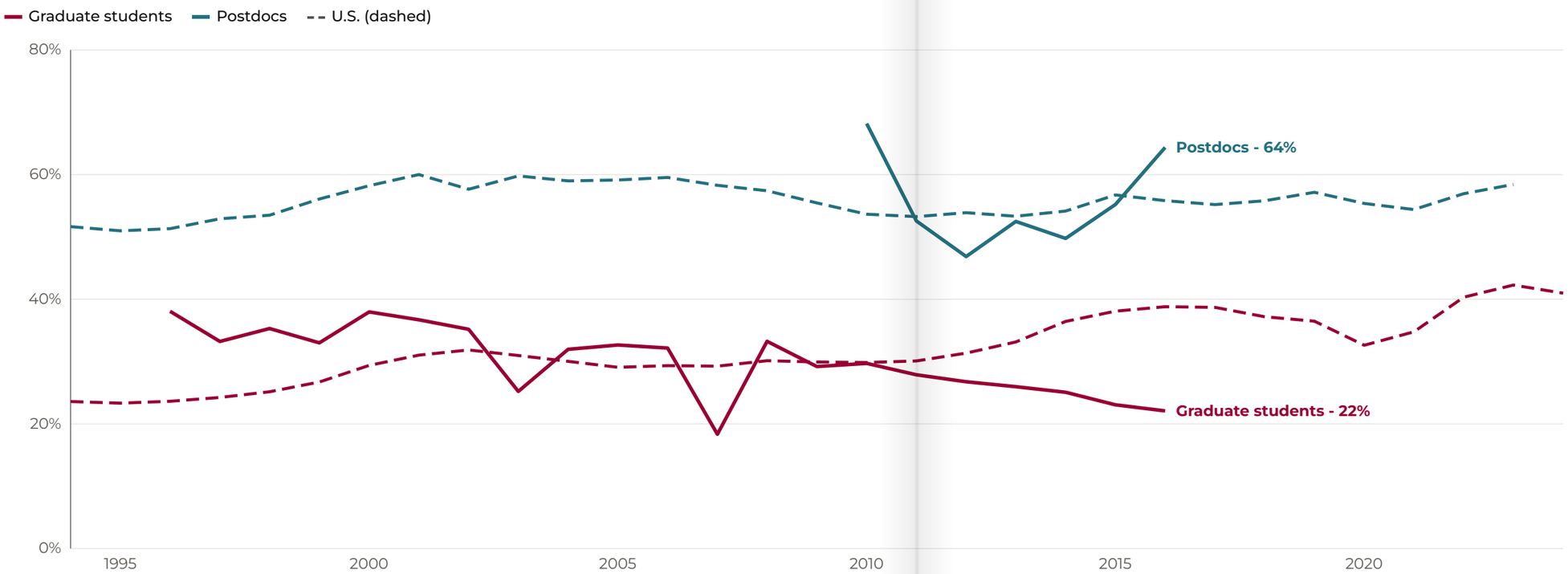
U.S. **257** · **25th** of 51 · −0.1 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

Hawaii ranks 46th of 51 on the temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students, at 22% in 2016 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of Hawaii's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 22% of Hawaii's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 46th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 64% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 202 research doctorates in 2025, 0.3% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

22%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **46th** of 51 · −1.0 pp since 2015

64%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **6th** of 51 · +9.1 pp since 2015

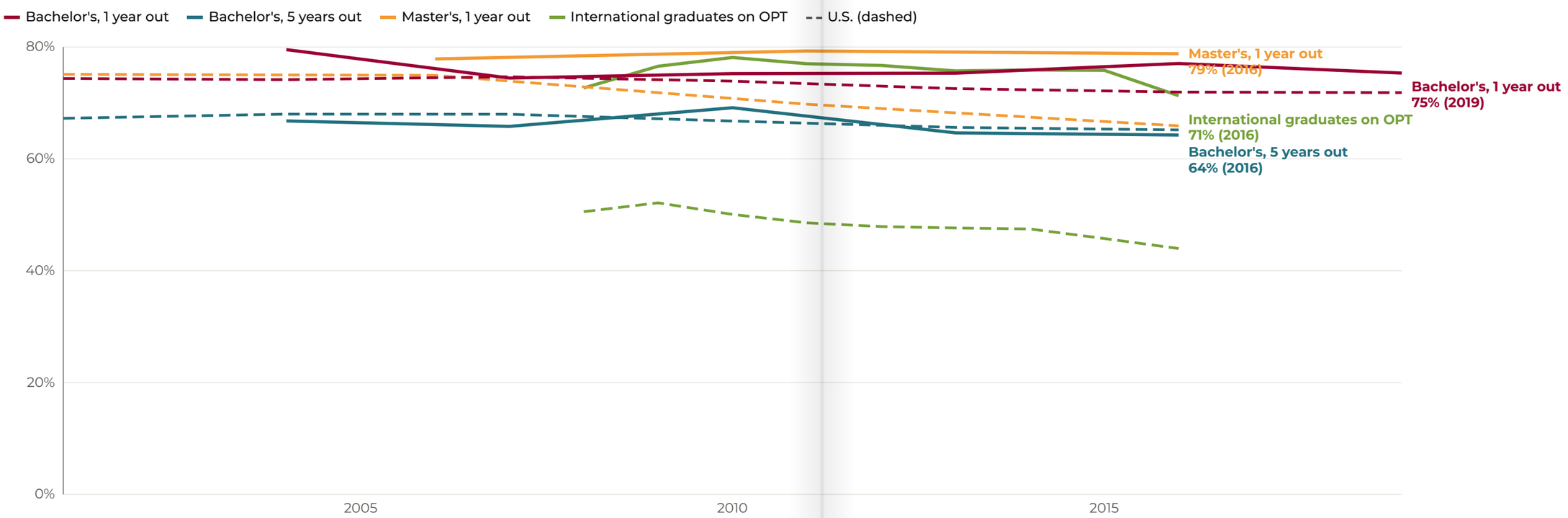
202
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **44th** of 51 · −16% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

Hawaii ranks 2nd of 51 on the share of international graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied, at 71% in 2016 against 44% for the U.S.

Figure 16 How Many of Hawaii's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of Hawaii's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 75% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 64%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 71% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state lost 3.5 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

75%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **8th** of 33 · −1.7 pp since 2016

71%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **2nd** of 51 · −4.5 pp since 2015

−3.5

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

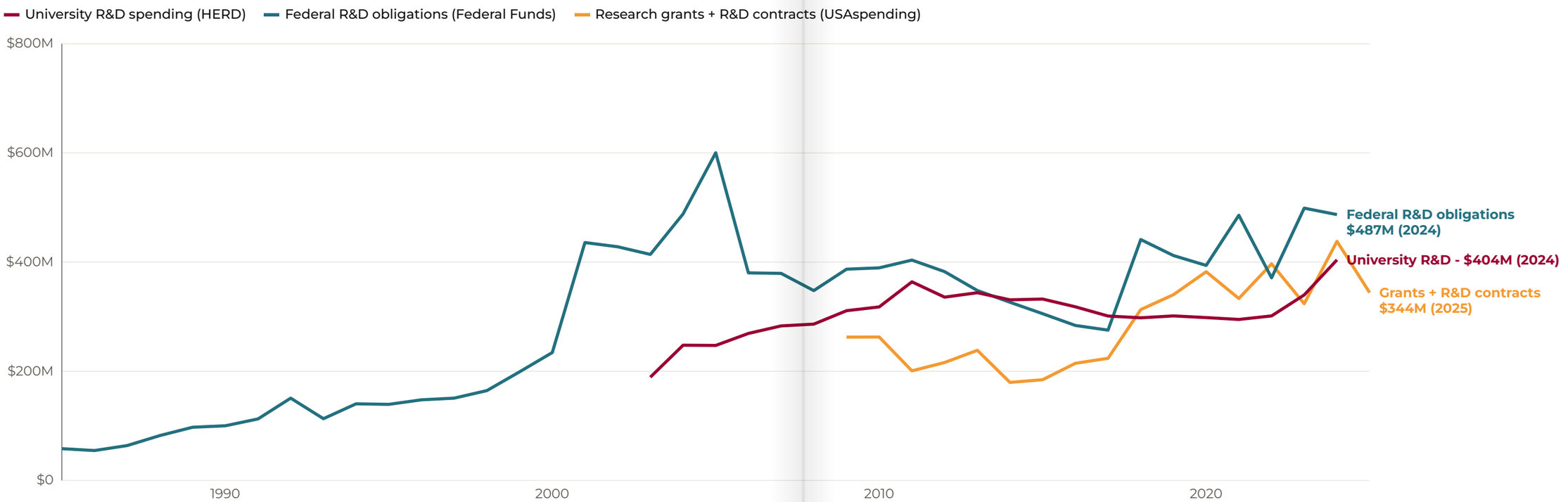
· **38th** of 51 · +1.0 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

Hawaii ranks 6th of 51 on the federally funded share of university R&D, at 65% in 2024 against 55% for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into Hawaii?



Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

Hawaii's universities spent $404M on research and development in FY2024, 42nd of 51 among the states; 65% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $487M for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$404M
University R&D spending, 2024
U.S. **$118B** · **42nd** of 51 · +22% since 2015

65%
Federal share of university R&D, 2024
U.S. **55%** · **6th** of 51 · +0.4 pp since 2015

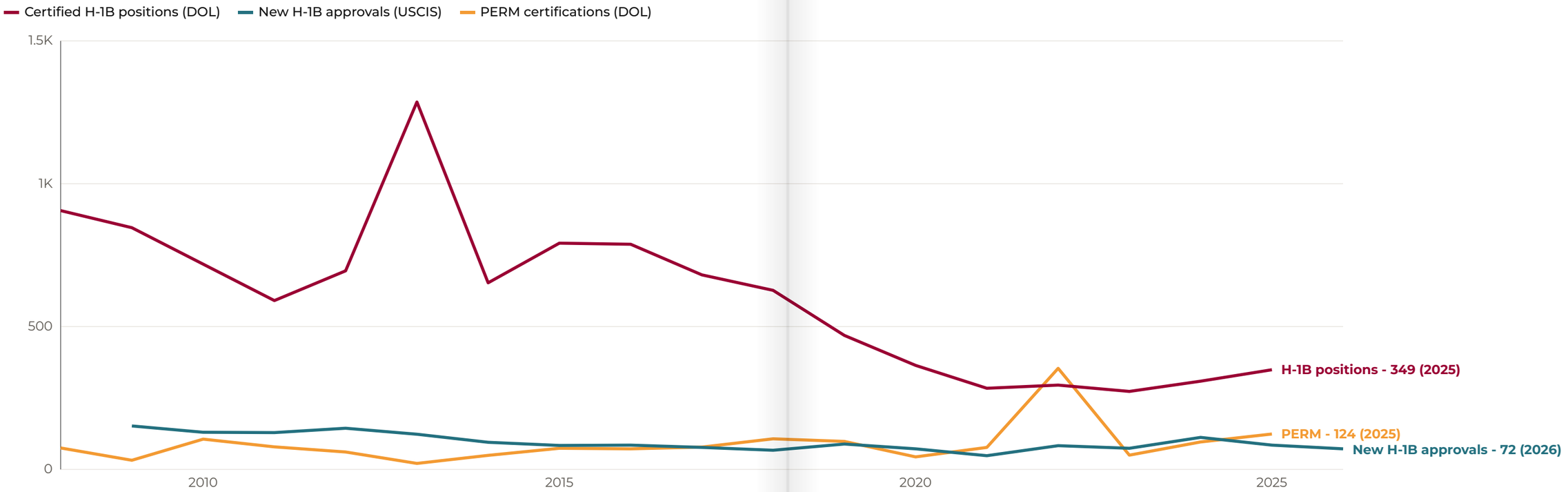
$487M
Federal R&D obligations, 2024
U.S. **$193B** · **38th** of 51 · +59% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

Hawaii ranks 2nd of 51 on the share of PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas, at 22% in 2024 against 8.7% for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does Hawaii Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 349 H-1B positions at Hawaii worksites in FY2025, 49th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 72 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 91 continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 124 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 22% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

349

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **49th** of 51 · −56% since 2015

124

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

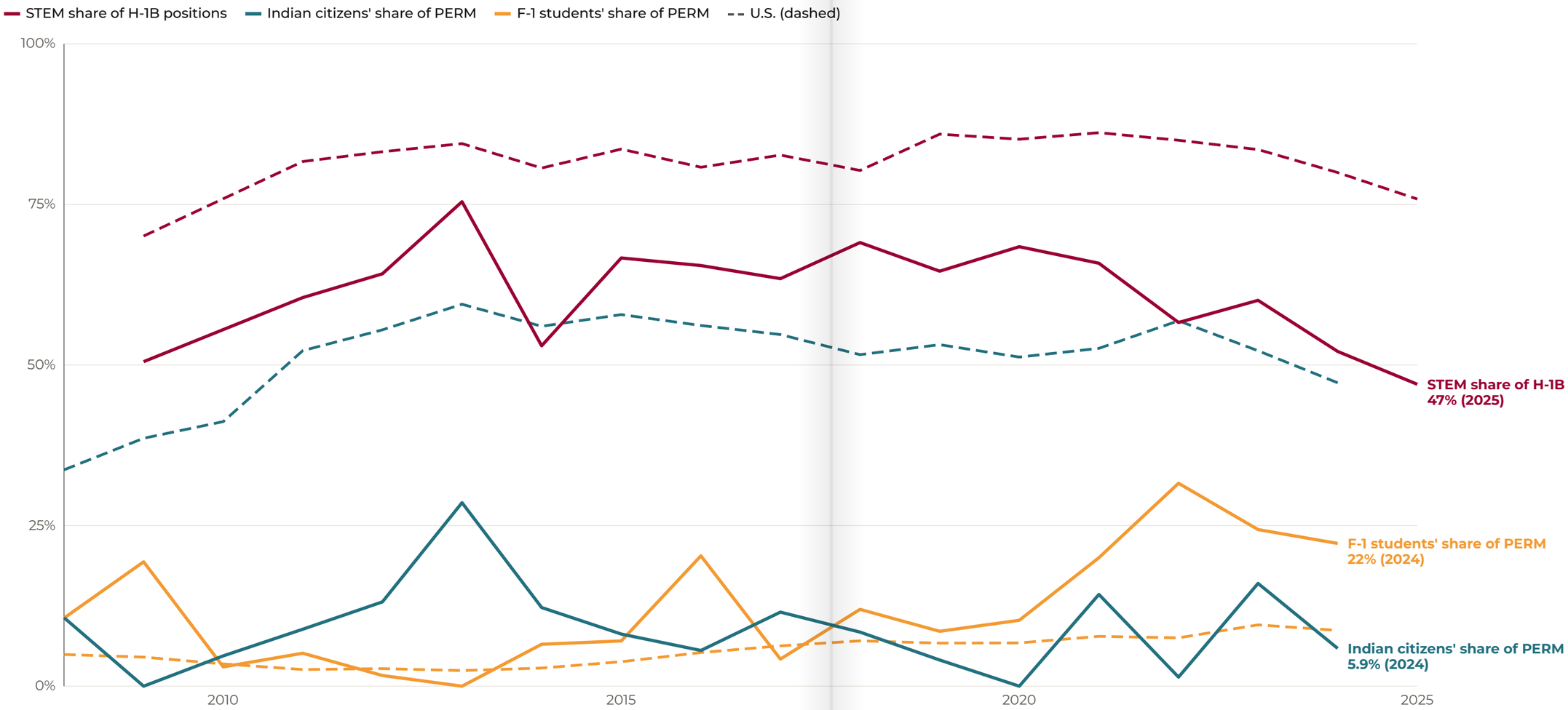
U.S. **138K** · **46th** of 51 · +68% since 2015

22%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **2nd** of 51 · +15.2 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds Hawaii's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

47% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 5.9% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

47%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **41st** of 51 · −19.7 pp since 2015

5.9%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **47th** of 51 · −2.2 pp since 2015

$90.7K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

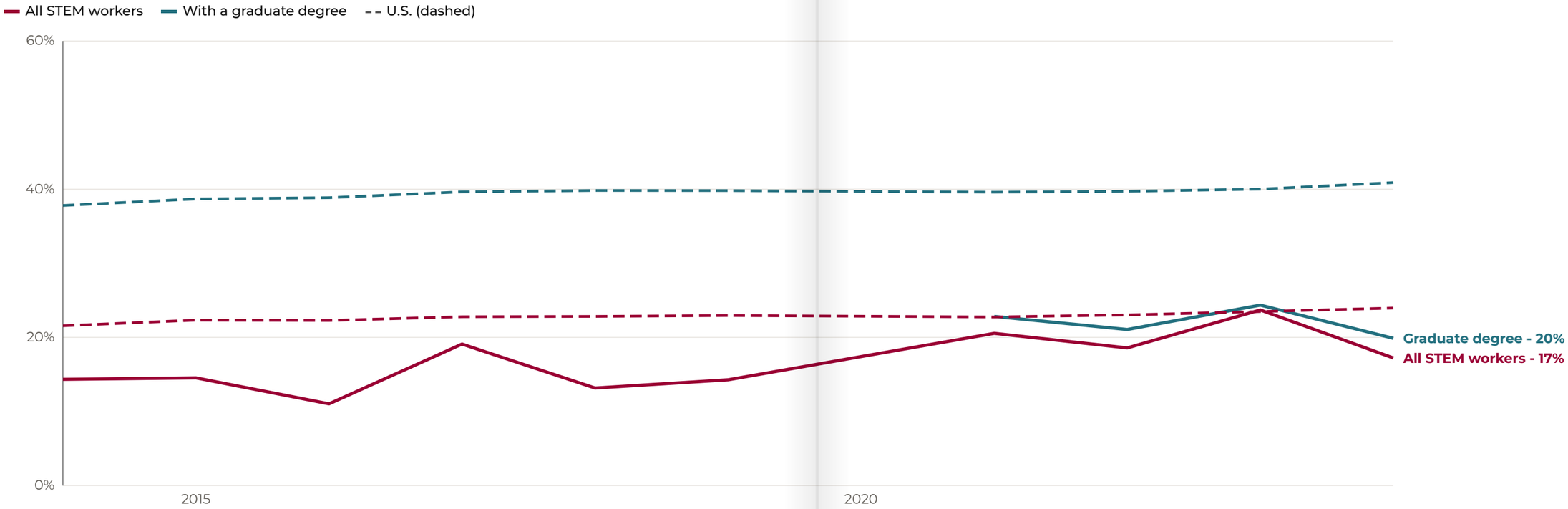
U.S. **$119K** · **40th** of 51 · +39% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

Hawaii ranks 38th of 44 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree, at 20% in 2024 against 41% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of Hawaii's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 17% of the people working in STEM occupations in Hawaii were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 19th of 51).

The share rises with education: 20% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 4.9% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

17%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **19th** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

20%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **38th** of 44 · −3.0 pp since 2021

4.9%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

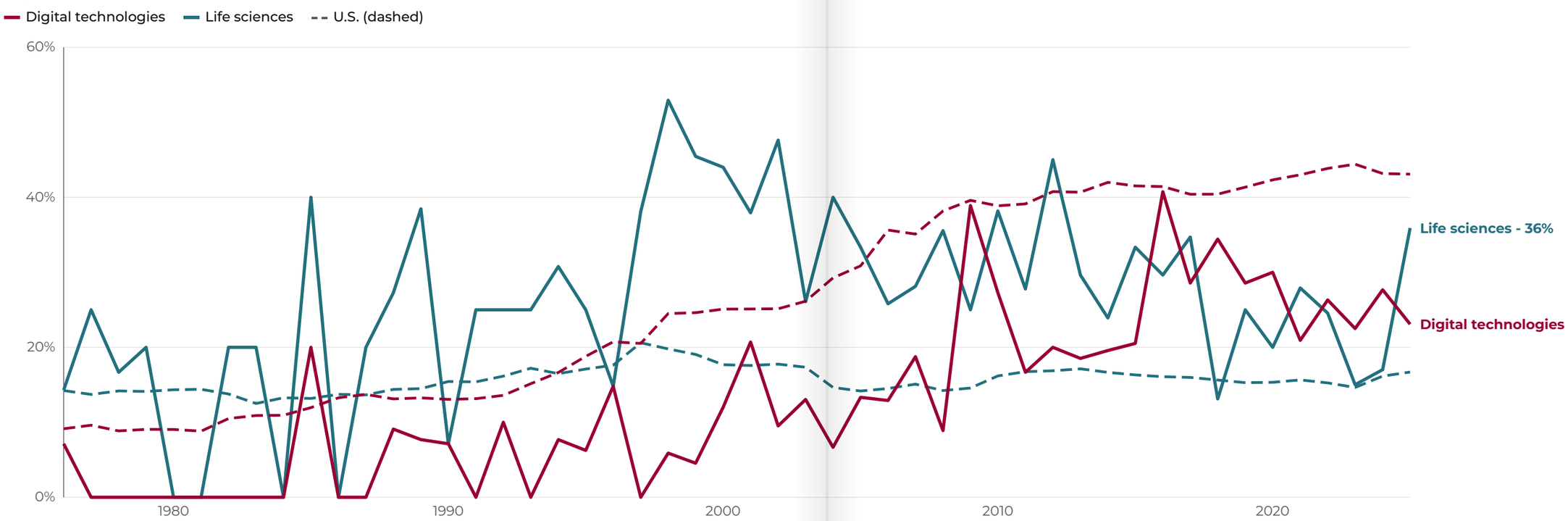
U.S. **11%** · **40th** of 51 · +0.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

Hawaii ranks 49th of 51 on patents granted to assignees in the state, at 38 in 2025 against 135K for the U.S.

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does Hawaii Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in Hawaii were granted 38 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.0% of all patents with a U.S. owner (49th of 51).

23% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 36% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

38

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **49th** of 51

23%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **25th** of 51 · +2.6 pp since 2015

36%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

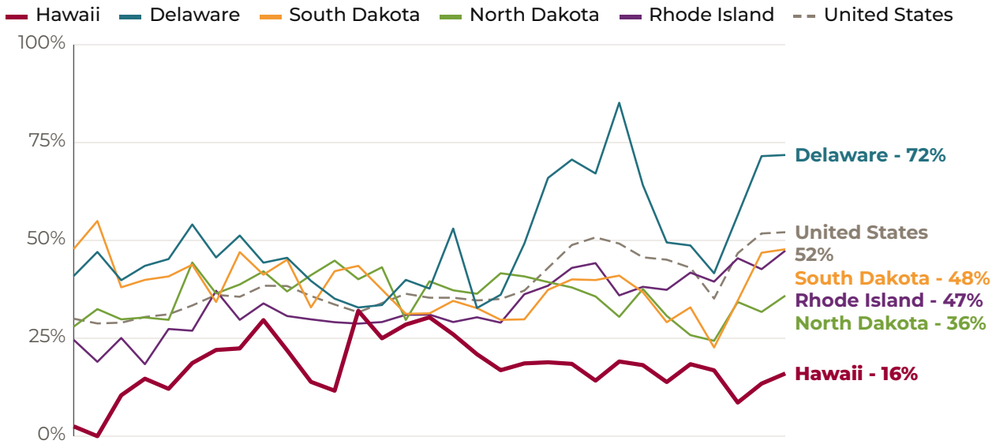
U.S. **17%** · **7th** of 51 · +2.6 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are Delaware, South Dakota, North Dakota, and Rhode Island. Hawaii ranks 5th of the five on the international share of STEM master's; Delaware is the most dependent at 72%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are Hawaii and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



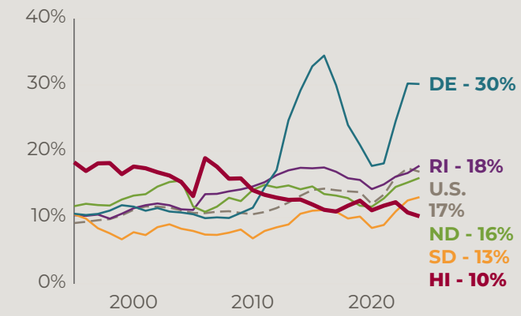
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does Hawaii Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	HI	DE	SD	ND	RI	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**61.4K**	57.8K	54.2K	53.5K	75.6K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**12%**	18%	17%	15%	16%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**20%**	22%	26%	21%	23%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**17%**	38%	27%	18%	23%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**40**	1.03K	277	122	406	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.0%**	0.9%	0.2%	0.1%	0.3%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**16%**	72%	48%	36%	47%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**35%**	52%	40%	57%	38%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**10%**	30%	13%	16%	18%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**6.2%**	3.5%	3.4%	2.7%	5.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**56%**	72%	58%	60%	74%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$10.4K**	$11.8K	$9.25K	$9.87K	$15.5K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$16.9K**	$8.9K	$9.61K	$11.9K	$8.67K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$110K**	$123K	$79.3K	$82.6K	$120K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**73%**	58%	58%	50%	41%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**–21**	+7	+22	+42	+58	–

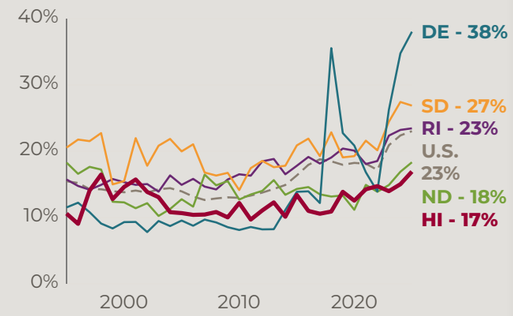
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



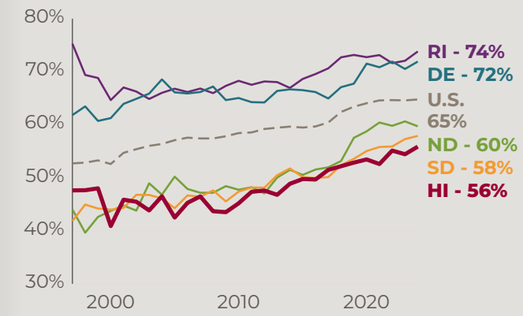
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



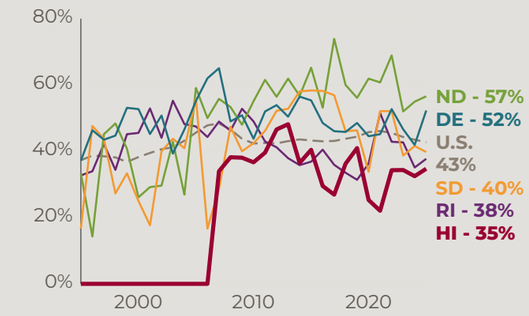
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

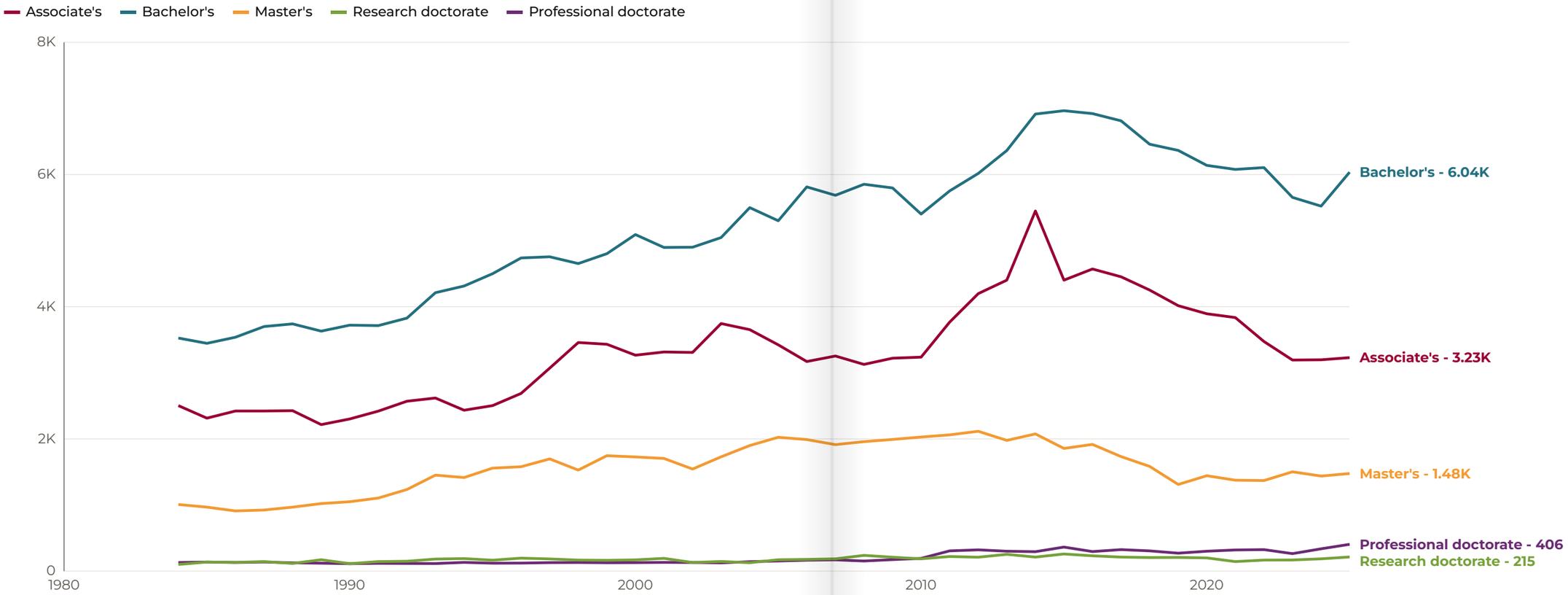


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does Hawaii Award?

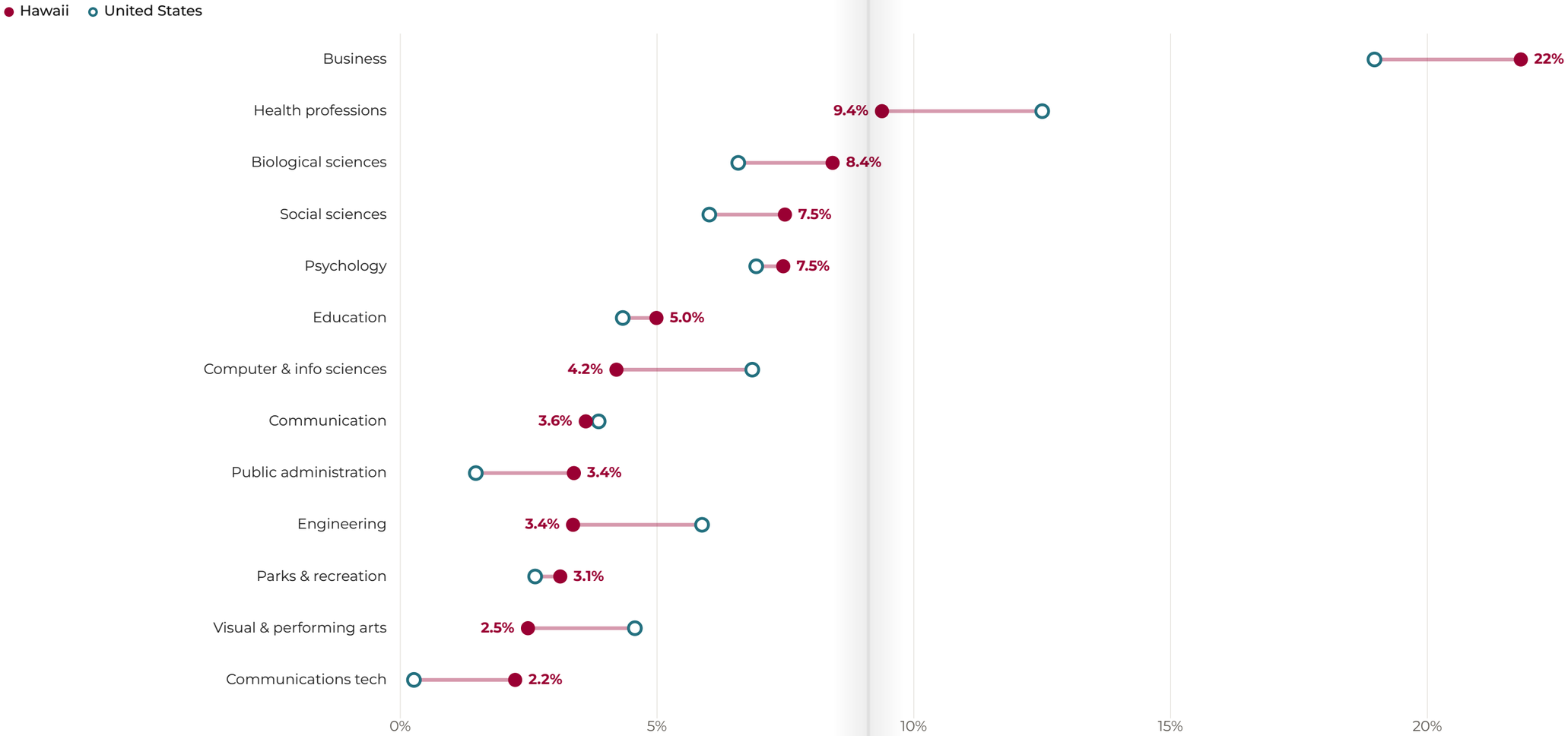


Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, Hawaii's institutions awarded 3.23K associate's degrees, 6.04K bachelor's degrees, 1.48K master's degrees, 215 research doctorate degrees, 406 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 27%; bachelor's down 13%; master's down 20%; research doctorate down 17%; professional doctorate up 12%. The state awards 11.2 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do Hawaii's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Hawaii's largest bachelor's fields are business (22%; U.S. 19%), health professions (9.4%; U.S. 13%), biological sciences (8.4%; U.S. 6.6%).

Relative to the nation, Hawaii's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in communications tech (8.42× the U.S. share), languages (3.01× the U.S. share), public administration (2.30× the U.S. share).

4.2%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **34th** of 51 · +1.2 pp since 2015

3.4%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

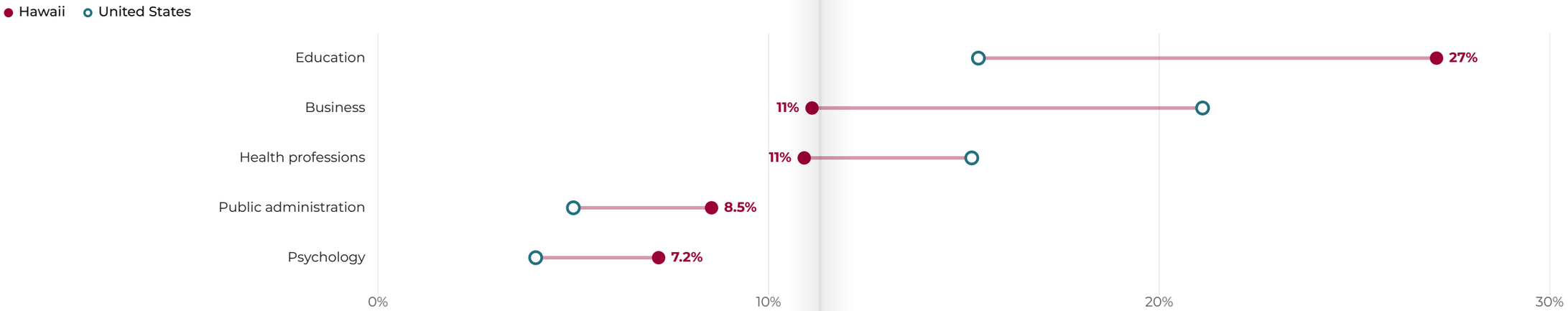
U.S. **6.8%** · **49th** of 51 · 0.0 pp since 2015

22%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **10th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do Hawaii's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Hawaii's largest master's fields are education (27%; U.S. 15%), business (11%; U.S. 21%), health professions (11%; U.S. 15%).

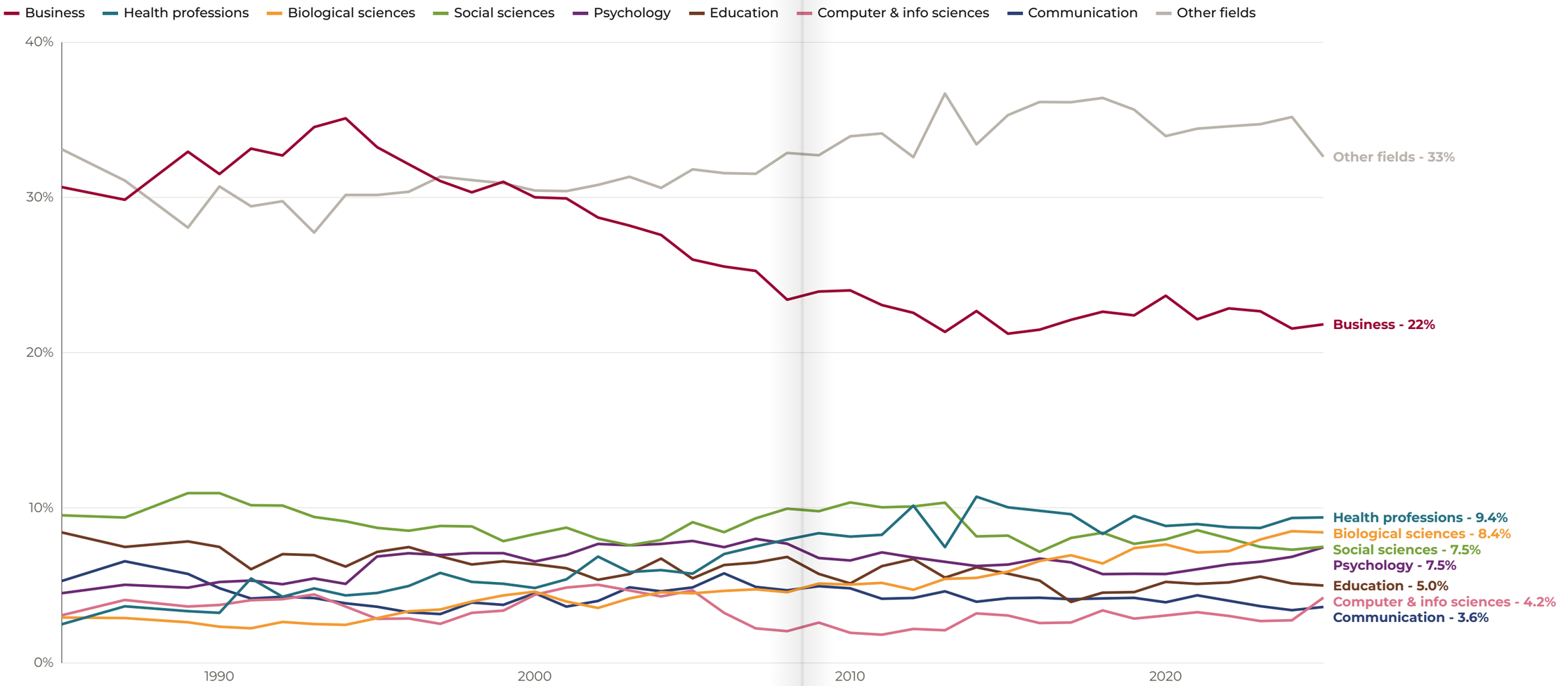
International students earn 8.9% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 17% of them.

17%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **35th** of 51 · +3.5 pp since 2015

8.9%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **41st** of 51 · −3.8 pp since 2015

20%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **44th** of 47 · −6.5 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has Hawaii's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, biological sciences has gained the most ground, 2.5 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while education lost the most (0.8 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is Hawaii Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of Hawaii's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Communications tech (8.42, with 2.2% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.3% for the U.S.), languages (3.01, with 1.7% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 0.6% for the U.S.), and public administration (2.30, with 3.4% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.5% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is Hawaii Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Communications tech	**8.42**	2.2%	0.3%	135
Languages	**3.01**	1.7%	0.6%	105
Public administration	**2.30**	3.4%	1.5%	204
Biological sciences	**1.28**	8.4%	6.6%	508
Social sciences	**1.25**	7.5%	6.0%	452
Parks & recreation	**1.19**	3.1%	2.6%	188
Education	**1.15**	5.0%	4.3%	301
Business	**1.15**	22%	19%	1.32K
Liberal arts	**1.13**	2.1%	1.8%	124
Psychology	**1.08**	7.5%	6.9%	450

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

20%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **42nd** of 51

4.2%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **34th** of 51

3.4%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **49th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 3.4% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 49th among the states, down 0.9 points from 4.2% in 2024 and unchanged since 2015, when it was 3.4%.

Health professions. The share was 9.4% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 41st among the states, unchanged from 9.3% in 2024 and down 0.7 points since 2015, when it was 10%.

Table 6 Hawaii at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	16%	20% 2024	**20% 2025**	+4.4 pp	24%	42nd
Bachelor's in computer science	3.1%	2.8% 2024	**4.2% 2025**	+1.2 pp	6.9%	34th
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	3.4%	4.2% 2024	**3.4% 2025**	0.0 pp	6.8%	49th
Bachelor's in business	21%	22% 2024	**22% 2025**	+0.6 pp	19%	10th

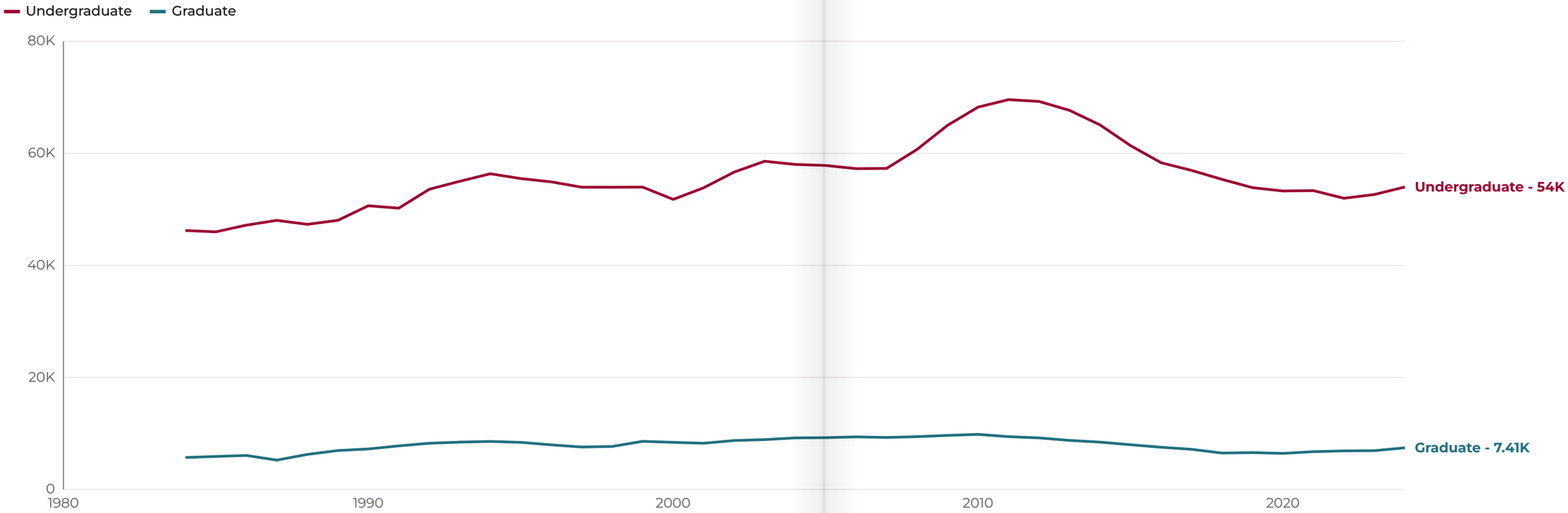
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

Hawaii ranks 45th of 51 on the share of students who are graduate students, at 12% in 2024 against 17% for the U.S.

Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, Hawaii enrolled 54K undergraduates and 7.41K graduate students, 61.4K in all (44th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 12% since 2015 and graduate enrollment down 7% since 2015. Graduate students are 12% of all students (U.S. 17%).

61.4K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **44th** of 51 · −11% since 2015

12%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **45th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2015

47%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **8th** of 51 · +5.5 pp since 2015

SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in Hawaii, and Where?

In fall 2024, Asian and Pacific Islander students were the largest group at Hawaii's degree-granting institutions, **33%** of enrollment against 7.4% nationally, down 4.3 points since 2015.

Students of two or more races were **26%** (U.S. 4.2%), up 1.3 points since 2015, and White students were **16%** (U.S. 45%), down 1.5 points since 2015.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in Hawaii?

Hawaii · United States

		Change since 2015
Asian / Pacific Islander	33% · U.S. 7.4%	−4.3 pts
Two or more	26% · U.S. 4.2%	+1.3 pts
White	16% · U.S. 45%	−1.5 pts
Hispanic	15% · U.S. 21%	+4.0 pts
International	6.7% · U.S. 5.3%	+0.8 pts
Black	1.8% · U.S. 12%	−0.3 pts
American Indian	0.2% · U.S. 0.6%	−0.0 pts

Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

33% Asian and Pacific Islander students — U.S. **7.4%** · −4.3 pp since 2015

26% Students of two or more races — U.S. **4.2%** · +1.3 pp since 2015

46% At public 4-year institutions — +4.3 pp since 2015

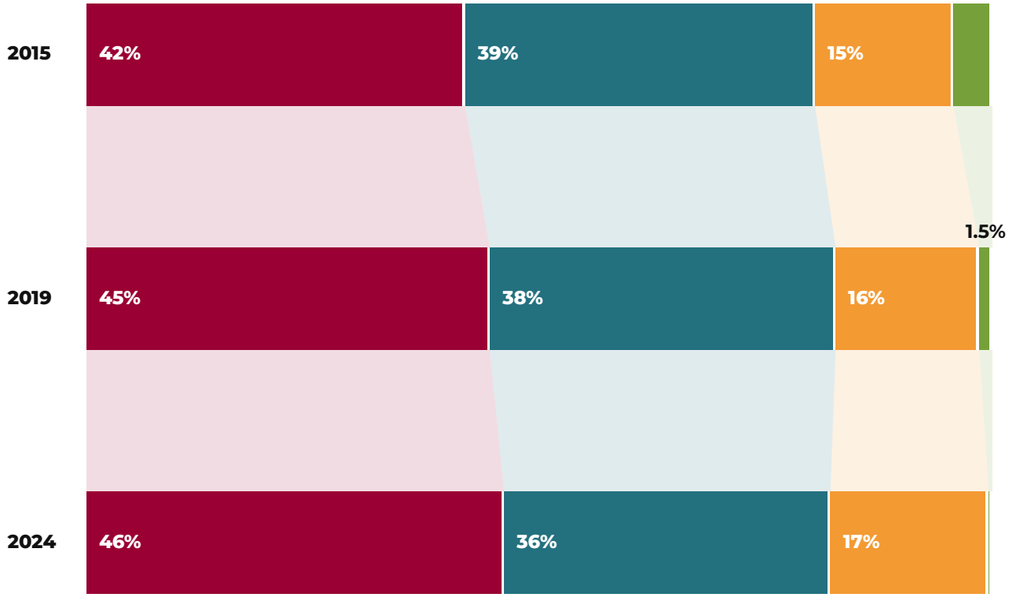
36% At public 2-year institutions — −2.6 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **46%** of students, up 4.3 points from 42% in 2015. Public 2-year institutions enrolled **36%** of students, down 2.6 points from 39% in 2015.

Private nonprofit institutions enrolled **17%** of students, up 2.2 points from 15% in 2015, and for-profit institutions enrolled **0.4%** of students, down 3.9 points from 4.3% in 2015.

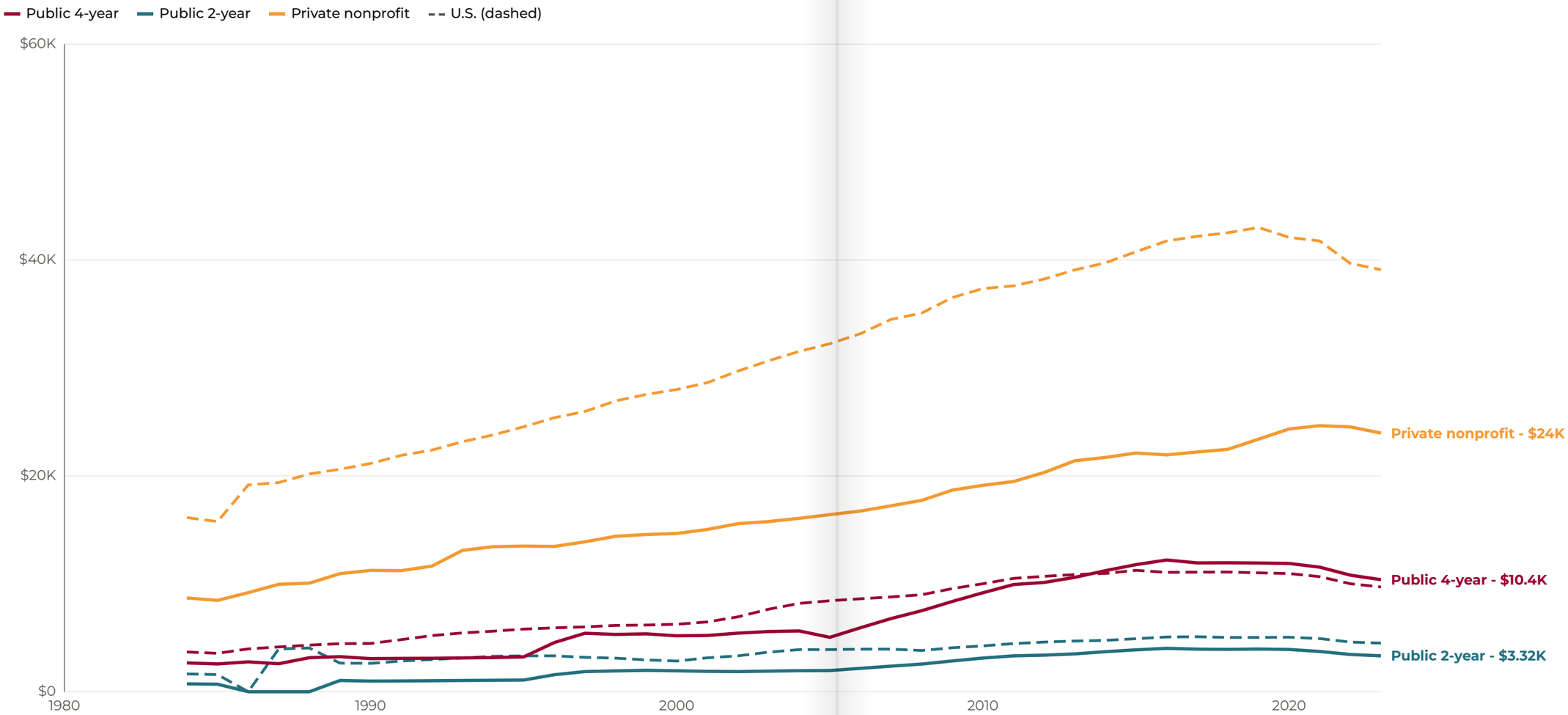
Public institutions together enrolled **82%** of students, against 73% nationally, 23rd among the states.

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at Hawaii's public four-year institutions are $10.4K (2023, 2024 dollars), 7% above the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 22nd of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $16.9K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (7th of 51), and net tuition makes up 30% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).

$10.4K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **22nd** of 51 · −12% since 2015

$16.9K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **7th** of 51 · +36% since 2015

30%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **44th** of 51 · −8.5 pp since 2015

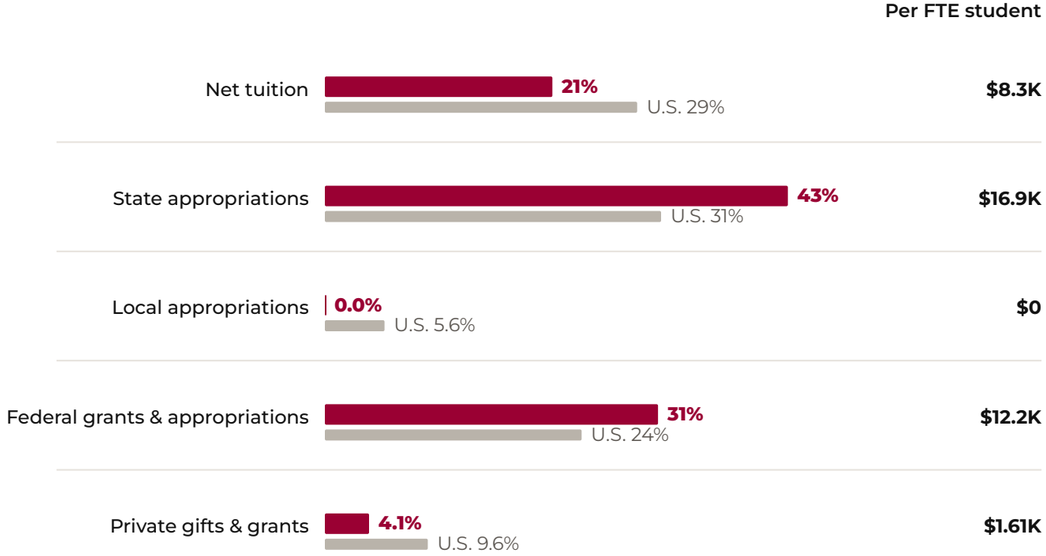
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are Hawaii's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of Hawaii's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $8.3K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 5.9% from $8.82K in FY2023 and down 5.4% since FY2015, when it was $8.78K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$10.4K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **22nd** of 51

$16.9K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **7th** of 51

30%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **44th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in Hawaii: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $10.4K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 22nd among the states, down 3.9% from $10.8K in 2022 and down 12% since 2015, when it was $11.8K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	Hawaii	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$10.4K**	$9.71K	22nd of 51	−12%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$16.9K**	$11.4K	7th of 51	+36%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**30%**	43%	44th of 51	−8.5 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**56%**	65%	42nd of 51	+6.1 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$110K**	$106K	13th of 51	−4.2%

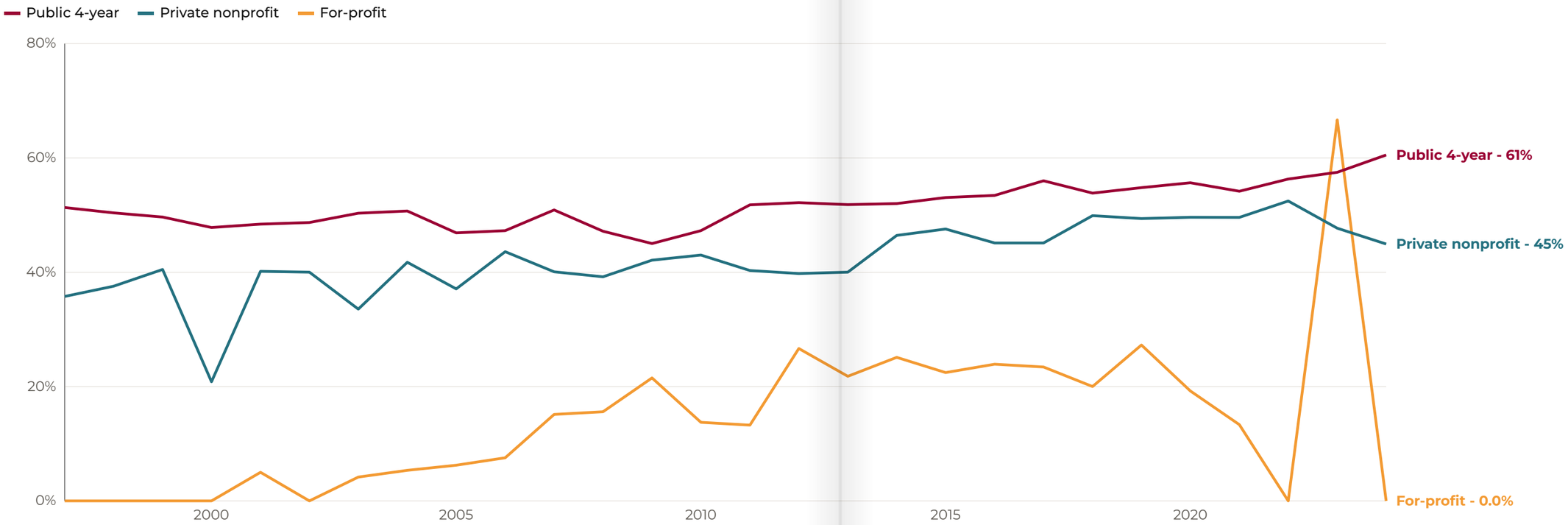
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

Hawaii ranks 42nd of 51 on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 56% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

56% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in Hawaii graduated within six years (2024), 8.9 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 42nd of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 61%, private nonprofit 45%, for-profit 0.0%. At two-year institutions, 37% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

56%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **42nd** of 51 · +6.1 pp since 2015

37%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **33rd** of 50 · +17.4 pp since 2015

11.2
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **40th** of 51 · +0.5 since 2015

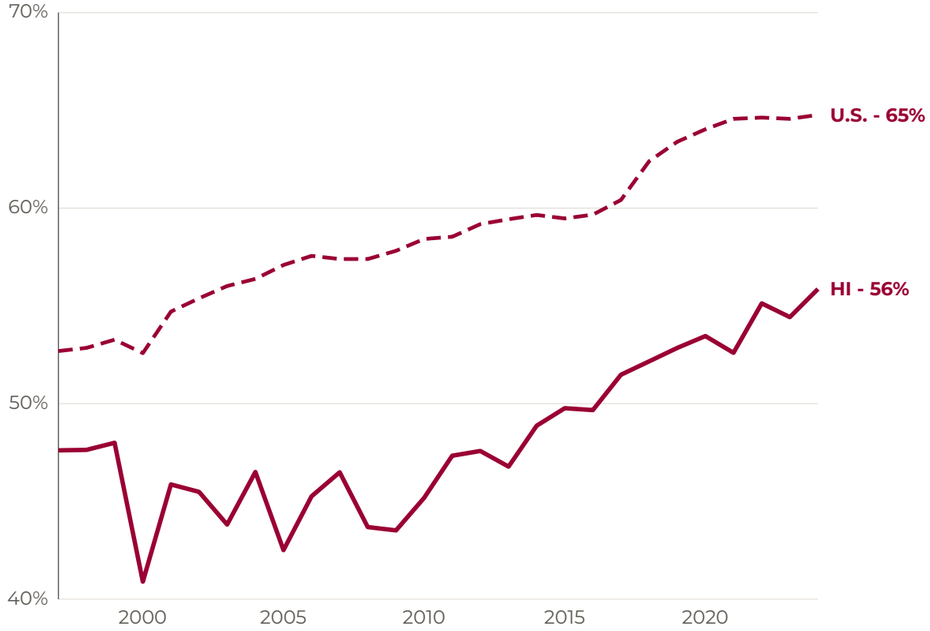
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of Hawaii's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at Hawaii's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (47% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 56% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 1.4 points from 54% in 2023 and up 6.1 points since 2015, when it was 50%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

56%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **42nd** of 51

37%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **33rd** of 50

11.2
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **40th** of 51

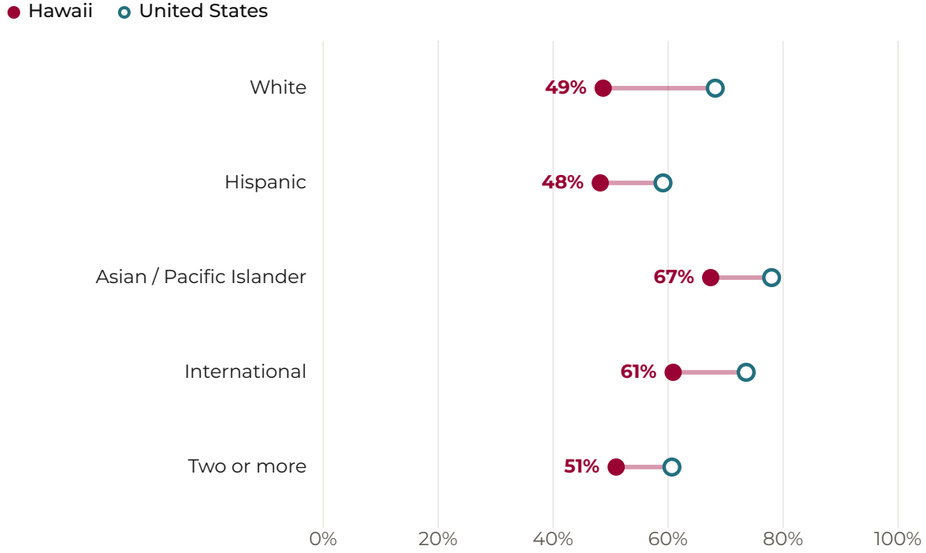
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at Hawaii's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 49% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 48% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 67% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



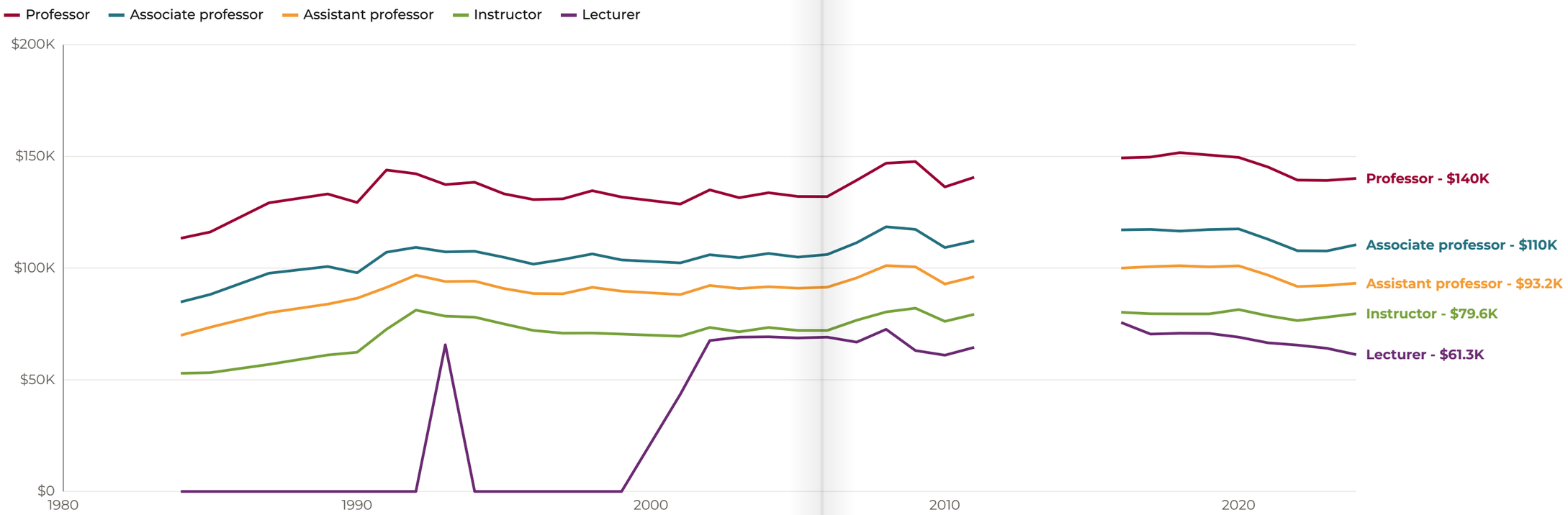
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

Hawaii ranks 13th of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $110K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 39 What Do Hawaii's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at Hawaii's institutions earned an average of $110K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 4% above the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 13th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $140K, associate professors $110K, assistant professors $93.2K, instructors $79.6K, lecturers $61.3K.

Hawaii's institutions had 2.38K full-time instructional staff in 2024, down 10% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 4% since 2016.

$110K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **13th** of 51 · −4.2% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

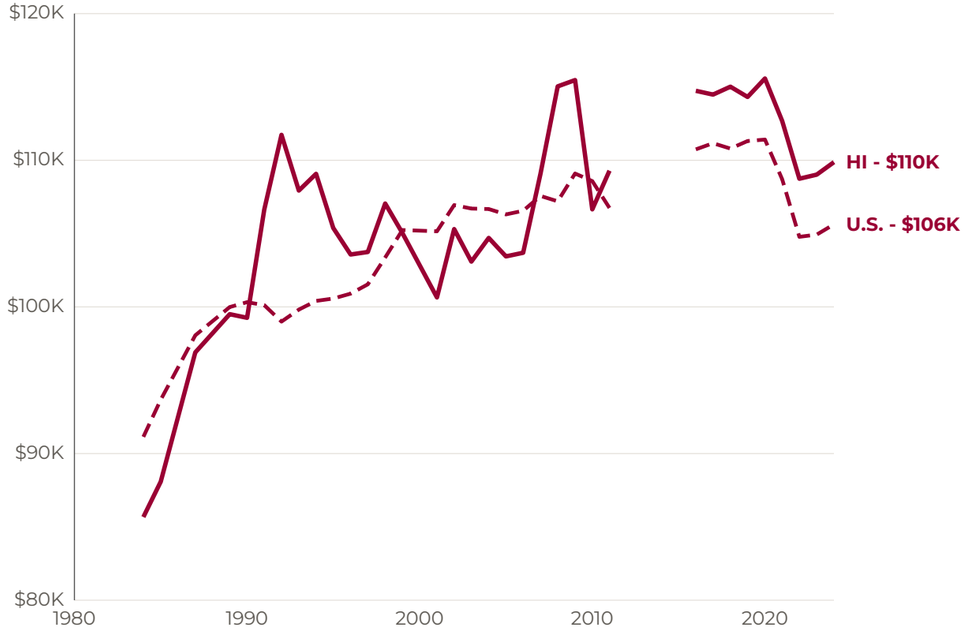
What Do Hawaii's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at Hawaii's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $110K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 13th among the states, up 0.8% from $109K in 2023 and down 4.2% since 2016, when it was $115K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 2.38K in 2024, up 2.8% from 2.32K in 2023 and down 10% since 2015, when it was 2.65K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$110K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **13th** of 51

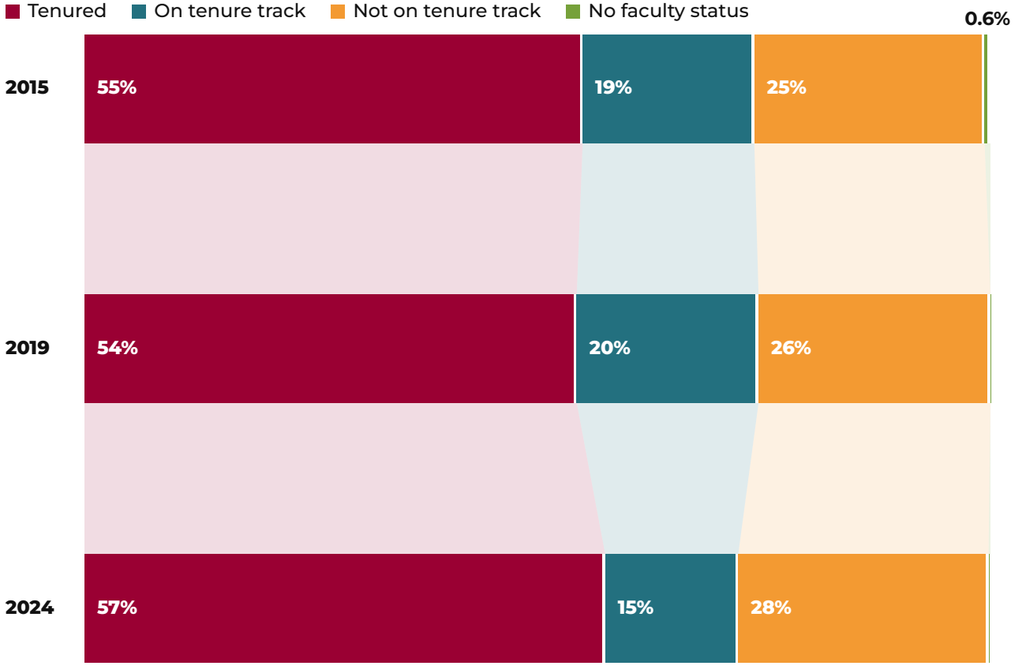
2.38K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

57%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide Hawaii's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 57% in 2024, down 1.5 points from 59% in 2023 and up 2.5 points since 2015, when it was 55%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



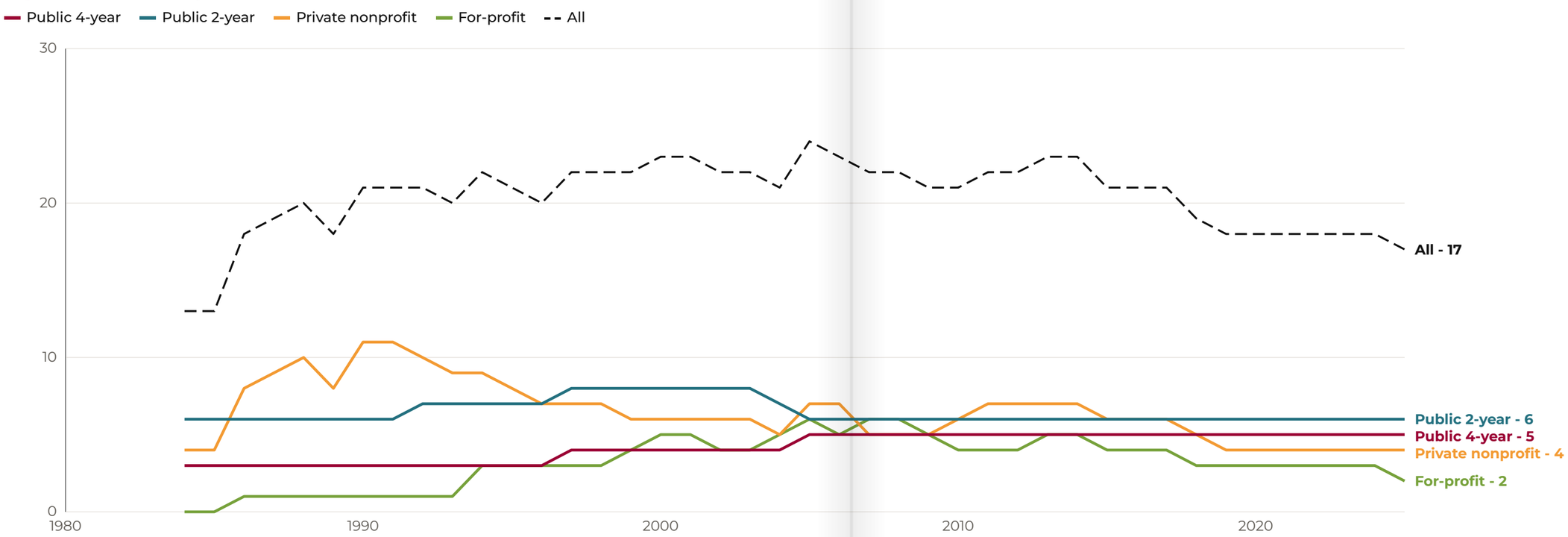
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

Hawaii ranks 39th of 51 on the share of enrollment at for-profit institutions, at 0.4% in 2024 against 5.5% for the U.S.

Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does Hawaii Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Hawaii has 17 degree-granting institutions:5 public 4-year, 6 public 2-year, 4 private nonprofit, 2 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 19% since 2015. 82% of students attend public institutions and 0.4% attend for-profit ones.

82%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **23rd** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

0.4%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **39th** of 51 · −3.9 pp since 2015

30%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **14th** of 51 · +17.9 pp since 2015

16

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in Hawaii?

The table lists Hawaii's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of Hawaii at Manoa (20K students), Leeward Community College (6.47K students), and Kapiolani Community College (5.91K students).

Degree-granting institutions. The state had 17 in 2025, and 16 of them reported the enrollment and degree data in these tables.

Table 8 What Are Hawaii's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of Hawaii at Manoa	**20K**	15%	817	64%	87%
Leeward Community College	**6.47K**	–	–	–	–
Kapiolani Community College	**5.91K**	–	–	–	–
Hawaii Pacific University	**4.92K**	3.3%	141	35%	86%
Honolulu Community College	**3.34K**	–	–	–	–
Brigham Young University-Hawaii	**2.91K**	–	112	50%	47%
University of Hawaii-West Oahu	**2.81K**	–	–	50%	95%
University of Hawaii Maui College	**2.79K**	–	–	–	–
Windward Community College	**2.77K**	–	–	–	–
Chaminade University of Honolulu	**2.71K**	0.7%	24	65%	91%

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

17
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

82%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **23rd** of 51

0.4%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **39th** of 51

30%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **14th** of 51

Share of students at public institutions. The share was 82% in 2024, against 73% for the U.S., 23rd among the states, unchanged from 82% in 2023 and up 1.7 points since 2015, when it was 80%.

Share at for-profit institutions. The share was 0.4% in 2024, against 5.5% for the U.S., 39th among the states, down 0.1 points from 0.5% in 2023 and down 3.9 points since 2015, when it was 4.3%.

Table 9 Hawaii at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
Students at public institutions	80%	82% 2023	**82% 2024**	+1.7 pp	73%	23rd
Students at for-profit institutions	4.3%	0.5% 2023	**0.4% 2024**	−3.9 pp	5.5%	39th
Students fully online	12%	30% 2023	**30% 2024**	+17.9 pp	27%	14th

Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

Hawaii – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	279	**270**[2024]	−9.3 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#30	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	30%	**23%**[2024]	−6.9 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#38	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	238	**239**[2024]	+1.4 ▲	237	−2.5 ▼	#14	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	38%	**42%**[2024]	+3.8 pp ▲	39%	0.0 pp	#13	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	257	**257**[2024]	−0.1 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#25	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	26%	**29%**[2024]	+3.4 pp ▲	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#23	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	215	**216**[2024]	+0.7 ▲	214	−7.1 ▼	#16	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**144**[2015]	–	153	–	#42	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$16.8K	**$19.5K**[2021]	+16% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#16	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	82%	**86%**[2022]	+4.0 pp ▲	87%	+4.0 pp ▲	#25	[3]
Public high school graduates	10.7K	**11.4K**[2024]	+6.5% ▲	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#42	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$74.8K	**$73.5K**[2022]	−1.7% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#15	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	15.5	**14.2**[2022]	−1.3 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#25	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	182K	**167K**[2024]	−8.2% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#41	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	50%	**46%**[2023]	−4.0 pp ▼	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#30	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	8.4%	**10%**[2022]	+1.6 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#14	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	5.7%	**7.1%**[2023]	+1.4 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#21	[3]
High schools offering calculus	24%[2016]	**51%**[2024]	+27.0 pp ▲	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#28	[14]
High schools offering physics	67%[2016]	**77%**[2024]	+10.3 pp ▲	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#13	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	84%[2016]	**80%**[2024]	−4.1 pp ▼	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#31	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	94%[2016]	**85%**[2024]	−9.0 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#42	[14]
High schools offering computer science	71%[2021]	**82%**[2024]	+10.6 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#4	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	67%[2016]	**58%**[2024]	−8.2 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#26	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	35%[2021]	**34%**[2024]	−1.6 pp ▼	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#15	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	90%[2016]	**94%[2024]**	+3.4 pp ▲	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#1	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	11.5[2016]	**12.8[2024]**	+1.2 ▲	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#35	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	0.8[2016]	**2.3[2024]**	+1.5 ▲	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#36	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	6.2[2016]	**17.0[2024]**	+10.8 ▲	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#5	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	23.7[2016]	**18.1[2024]**	−5.6 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#29	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	2.9[2016]	**0.5[2024]**	−2.4 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#47	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	32%	**28%[2025]**	−3.4 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#44	[15]
Fall enrollment	69.3K	**61.4K[2024]**	−11% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#44	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	80%	**82%[2024]**	+1.7 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#23	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	4.3%	**0.4%[2024]**	−3.9 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	41%	**47%[2024]**	+5.5 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#8	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	11%	**12%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#45	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	12%	**30%[2024]**	+17.9 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#14	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	240	**202[2025]**	−16% ▼	59K	+7.3% ▲	#44	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	152	**135[2025]**	−11% ▼	44.4K	+14% ▲	#44	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.4%	**0.3%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#44	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	15	**17[2025]**	–	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#47	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	8	**7[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#46	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	2.6	**2.6[2025]**	−0.1 ▼	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#49	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	16%	**20%[2025]**	+4.4 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	3.1%	**4.2%[2025]**	+1.2 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#34	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	3.4%	**3.4%[2025]**	0.0 pp	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#49	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.4%[2025]**	−0.3 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#49	[4]

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HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	5.9%	**8.4%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	0.8%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.5 pp ▲	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#26	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	10%	**9.4%**[2025]	−0.7 pp ▼	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#41	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	21%	**22%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#10	[4]
STEM share of master's	13%	**17%**[2025]	+3.5 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	3.7%	**3.0%**[2025]	−0.6 pp ▼	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#43	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	2.6%	**5.1%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#31	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	0.4%	**1.3%**[2025]	+0.9 pp ▲	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#19	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	2.0%	**2.2%**[2025]	+0.2 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	1.9%	**1.8%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#9	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	8.4%	**11%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#43	[4]
Share of master's in business	27%	**11%**[2025]	−15.6 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#51	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	36%	**46%**[2025]	+9.4 pp ▲	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#18	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	1.2%	**3.7%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#23	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	10%	**11%**[2025]	+0.7 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#35	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	1.9%	**0.9%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#43	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	11%	**17%**[2025]	+5.6 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#5	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	8.8%	**13%**[2025]	+4.2 pp ▲	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#6	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	4.6%	**5.6%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#38	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	4.2%	**4.7%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#16	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	10.7	**11.2**[2025]	+0.5 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#40	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	4.5%[2016]	**5.3%**[2024]	+0.8 pp ▲	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#5	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	47	**40**[2025]	–	117K	2.18× ▲	#47	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.1%	**0.0%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#47	[4]

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HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	5.1%	**6.2%**[2024]	+1.1 pp ▲	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#2	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	12%	**10%**[2024]	−1.8 pp ▼	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#36	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	7.6%	**7.2%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#3	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	5.1%	**8.3%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#7	[4]
International share of all master's	13%	**8.9%**[2025]	−3.8 pp ▼	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of STEM master's	19%	**16%**[2025]	−2.9 pp ▼	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#46	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	26%	**20%**[2025]	−6.5 pp ▼	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#44	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	17%	**17%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#48	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	16%	**19%**[2025]	+2.5 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#23	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	20%	**23%**[2023]	+2.9 pp ▲	26%	−3.3 pp ▼	#22	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	27%	**31%**[2025]	+4.2 pp ▲	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#10	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	40%	**35%**[2025]	−5.7 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#41	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences research doctorates	16%[2017]	**33%**[2025]	+17.2 pp ▲	23%	−2.3 pp ▼	#3	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	–	**34%**[2019]	–	39%	–	#29	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	4.8K	**2.68K**[2026]	−44% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#44	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.4%	**0.2%**[2026]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#44	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	0.5%	**1.5%**[2026]	+1.0 pp ▲	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#51	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	10%	**8.8%**[2026]	−1.2 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#33	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	50%	**40%**[2026]	−10.1 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#23	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	114	**101**[2026]	−11% ▼	219	−2.7% ▼	#48	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	543	**688**[2026]	+27% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#47	[20]
Active STEM master's students	104	**177**[2026]	+70% ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#47	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	174	**271**[2026]	+56% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#47	[20]
Share of STEM master's students from India	5.8%	**21%**[2026]	+15.7 pp ▲	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#50	[20]

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HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	538[2017]	**701[2024]**	+30% ▲	–	–	#44	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$121M[2018]	**$125M[2024]**	+2.9% ▲	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#37	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	1.01K[2018]	**762[2024]**	−25% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#39	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.4%[2024]**	0.0 pp	–	–	#36	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.4%	**0.3%[2024]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#38	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.5%	**0.6%[2024]**	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#35	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1.64K	**1.93K[2025]**	+17% ▲	275K	−14% ▼	#35	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	2.03K	**1.87K[2016]**	−8.2% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#44	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	469	**412[2016]**	−12% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#45	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	23%	**22%[2016]**	−1.0 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#46	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	32%	**33%[2016]**	+1.2 pp ▲	57%	0.0 pp	#48	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	201	**202[2016]**	+0.5% ▲	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#36	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	55%	**64%[2016]**	+9.1 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#6	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$332M	**$404M[2024]**	+22% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#42	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.5%	**0.3%[2024]**	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#42	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	64%	**65%[2024]**	+0.4 pp ▲	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#6	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	2.0%	**0.9%[2024]**	−1.1 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#49	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	4.3%	**4.8%[2024]**	+0.6 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#28	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$22.3M	**$31.7M[2024]**	+42% ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#31	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$24.1M	**$31.2M[2024]**	+30% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#49	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	5.05K	**3.92K[2024]**	−23% ▼	1.09M	+20% ▲	#43	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$305M	**$487M[2024]**	+59% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#38	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$135M	**$186M[2024]**	+38% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#39	[8]
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$157M	**$277M[2024]**	+76% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#30	[8]

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HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$49.4M	**$74.2M[2024]**	+50% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#43	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$110M	**$139M[2025]**	+26% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#39	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$74.5M	**$134M[2026]**	+59.9 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#29	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$51.3K[2020]	**$51.9K[2022]**	+1.2% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#13	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$44.5K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#46	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$12.9K	**$18.8K[2024]**	+45% ▲	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#32	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$45.7K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#51	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$45.9K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#45	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$59.3K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#48	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$49.7K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#48	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	50%	**56%[2024]**	+6.1 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#42	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	19%	**37%[2024]**	+17.4 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#33	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$11.8K	**$10.4K[2023]**	−12% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#22	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$12.4K	**$16.9K[2024]**	+36% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#7	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	39%	**30%[2024]**	−8.5 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#44	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$115K[2016]	**$110K[2024]**	−4.2% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#13	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	76%	**71%[2016]**	−4.5 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#2	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	75%	**71%[2016]**	−3.6 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#6	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	80%	**63%[2016]**	−17.2 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#4	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	60%	**63%[2016]**	+3.4 pp ▲	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#2	[21]
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	1.01	**0.91[2016]**	−0.1 ▼	1.00	0.0	#22	[21]

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HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	24	**22**[2016]	–	41.2K	+51% ▲	#48	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	77%[2016]	**75%**[2019]	−1.7 pp ▼	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#8	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**64%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#13	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 10 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**62%**[2010]	–	64%	–	#16	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	70%[2016]	**71%**[2019]	+1.8 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#7	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**79%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#3	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**52%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#13	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$41.6K[2016]	**$41.5K**[2019]	−0.2% ▼	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#33	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$60.8K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#31	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$48.2K[2016]	**$45.2K**[2019]	−6.2% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#33	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−4.5	**−3.5**[2025]	+1.0 ▲	–	–	#38	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	−266	**+461**[2025]	+727.0 ▲	–	–	#19	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	4.2%	**4.1%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#7	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	4.7%	**4.4%**[2025]	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#2	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	4.67K	**2.44K**[2025]	−48% ▼	–	–	#36	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	77%[2016]	**73%**[2024]	−4.2 pp ▼	–	–	#24	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	−24[2016]	**−21**[2024]	+2.4 ▲	–	–	#49	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	41%[2016]	**45%**[2022]	+3.4 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#6	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	792	**349**[2025]	−56% ▼	914K	−24% ▼	#49	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	67%	**47%**[2025]	−19.7 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#41	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$65.1K	**$90.7K**[2025]	+39% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#40	[17]

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HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	36%	**3.4%**^{2025}	−32.8 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#49	[17]
Green-card labor certifications	74	**124**^{2025}	+68% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#46	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	8.1%	**5.9%**^{2024}	−2.2 pp ▼	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#47	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	7.0%	**22%**^{2024}	+15.2 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#2	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	50%	**15%**^{2024}	−34.7 pp ▼	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#45	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	26%	**17%**^{2025}	−9.3 pp ▼	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#44	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$63.4K	**$54.6K**^{2025}	−14% ▼	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#36	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	6.51K	**4.79K**^{2024}	−26% ▼	1.36M	+30% ▲	#36	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.6%	**0.4%**^{2024}	−0.3 pp ▼	–	–	#36	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	3.7K	**3.67K**^{2024}	−0.8% ▼	819K	+12% ▲	#31	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.5%	**0.4%**^{2024}	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#31	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.1%**^{2024}	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#46	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**^{2024}	0.0 pp	–	–	#42	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**^{2024}	0.0 pp	–	–	#44	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.2%**^{2024}	0.0 pp	–	–	#29	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	84	**72**^{2026}	−14% ▼	127K	+14% ▲	#50	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	113	**91**^{2026}	−19% ▼	268K	+52% ▲	#50	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.1%	**0.1%**^{2026}	0.0 pp	–	–	#50	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	5.6%	**6.5%**^{2026}	+0.9 pp ▲	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#2	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	26%	**26%**^{2026}	+0.2 pp ▲	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#18	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	38%	**31%**^{2026}	−7.5 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#24	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	56%	**57%**^{2026}	+1.0 pp ▲	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#9	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	35.6K	**45.2K**^{2024}	+27% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#42	[12]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

HAWAII – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.0%	**6.1%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#41	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	15%	**17%**[2024]	+2.7 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#19	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	23%[2021]	**20%**[2024]	−3.0 pp ▼	41%	+1.3 pp ▲	#38	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	4.4%	**4.9%**[2024]	+0.5 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#40	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	1.9%	**3.1%**[2024]	+1.2 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#43	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	18%	**18%**[2025]	+0.3 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#8	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	14%	**16%**[2025]	+2.1 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#18	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	25.6K	**31.9K**[2025]	+25% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#43	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	0.69	**0.76**[2025]	+0.1 ▲	1.00	0.0	#39	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$75.7K	**$101K**[2025]	+34% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#32	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$90.8K[2019]	**$124K**[2025]	+37% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#31	[10]
Software developer jobs	1.65K	**1.6K**[2025]	−3.0% ▼	1.69M	+48% ▲	#48	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$47.7K	**$70.3K**[2025]	+47% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#17	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	38	**38**[2025]	–	135K	−0.6% ▼	#49	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.0%	**0.0%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#49	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	21%	**23%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#25	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	33%	**36%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#7	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	2.6%	**0.0%**[2025]	−2.6 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#44	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	6.7%	**7.8%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#47	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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